

BOOK SIX

WELCOME TO HELL



Devil
IN THE **WATERS**

KT MORRISON

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Welcome To Hell

Devil In The Waters

KT Morrison

Contents

[About the Author](#)

[More Licorice Books](#)

[Introduction](#)

I. Friday, August 14

1. Closed Doors

2. Truth

3. Confession

II. Saturday, August 15

4. Hell

5. Arrival

6. Company

7. Toy

8. Working

9. Whelk

10. Bravado

11. Talking

12. Playing

[Afterword](#)

About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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All characters are over the age of eighteen.

WELCOME TO HELL

A Devil In The Waters Novel

Book 6

33,000 words

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Introduction

A year ago I began a Patreon. It's a website where creators can garner support from their fans who wish to be patrons.

The aim of my Patreon is to help support the quicker finishing of series' I have still left hanging, and in return I offer a frequent-update series appearing first on Patreon where all the patrons analyze and debate every character's actions and motivations—it's grown to a great and active little community . . .

for more info:

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I



Friday, August 14

Closed Doors

The fight had probably begun on Wednesday night when she'd scolded Josh for not getting Friday off work. Josh had overreacted—in her opinion—like he was stressed out by the whole process of this impromptu vacation. She'd even chided him, saying, "Maybe it's best if we don't go at all," which made Josh acquiesce.

"Of course I can get the day off, Kimmy," he'd said then, "I just didn't get a chance to ask today. Hell, maybe I'll just call in sick on Friday . . ."

"Right," she'd said (maybe too snidely), "and come back on Monday with a tan?"

That'd calmed him, getting him working to make her less mad. "Like I said, I'll get the day off. I'm going to Cayman with you. Don't worry."

"I just don't understand how it'd slip your mind to do it today."

"It didn't slip my mind. Whenever I swung by Harjeet's office he was busy with something, and I never got a chance to connect with him."

"He has email, Josh."

Josh had said, "I like to meet with my boss when I need something like this."

Now it was Friday night, the sun gone down, and they were far from home. All the way in the Caribbean, on the island of Grand Cayman, the inside crook of the West Bay curl, at a four-cottage estate. Each of the four cottages shared amenities like a main house, a bar, a gym, a swimming

pool, but the cottages were completely separated by gardens and lawns, and each had their own access to a sandy beach, a short walk through a barrier of evergreen thickets and towering palms.

Through the door to the bedroom, she said to him, “I’m sorry, Josh. Can you please come out now?”

She stood in the hall outside the bedroom, leaning on the wall; Josh was in there by himself.

It took him a moment to answer, but finally his voice from the other side: “I’m fine, Kimmy.” Though his tone didn’t sound fine. Surly. Which she supposed was better than being hurt. Because she did feel as though she’d hurt his feelings. Now he said, “It’s not like I’m sulking or anything. I’ll be out in a minute, I just need a bit to get my thoughts together.”

She said, “I didn’t mean it the way it sounded.”

“I know,” he said, his tone firm and flat.

It had come out of nowhere. They’d taken an Uber to the Toronto Island airport, their bags taken for them, and loaded on the small private jet Stone Brokerage had arranged. Everything had been fine. An amazing flight. One they had to share with two other lawyers unrelated to Stone, but the lawyers kept to their sides of the plane after some brief small talk, and it was practically like her and Josh alone on a private jet. They had champagne. They had brunch. Grapefruit and crepes and chicken salad. They fly into Owen Roberts on Grand Cayman, disembark into that hot baking sun, and Josh isn’t giving anything away like he’s about to unload on her. Maybe she could see now there were some things that had made him stiff on the plane ride, but she’d just chalked it up to her husband being a little miffed that it was his high school bully who’d arranged for them such an amazing adventure on a private plane to the Caribbean . . .

They took an airport limo from George Town up to the northern point of Grand Cayman, dipping into the east side wilderness of West Bay. The estate where they were staying was spectacular, the airport limo coming in between iron gates that opened for them, winding through a perfect asphalt

strip that toured through the property to get to the main house. They checked in, took a golf cart to get to their cottage, this beautiful turquoise A-frame with bright white trim and Caribbean wooden shutters, manicured gardens, all the insides painted in tropical colors, pale leather furniture. She was walking around astounded, but it turns out Josh was preparing himself to get it all off of his chest. He did, and then she'd said the thing that had made him so mad. And also divulged that she knew more about what was going on than Josh thought.

She tapped the door again with her fingertip, saying softly, "Come on, Josh, come on, baby."



The idea to bare it all to Kimmy had come to him in bed the night before they left for Cayman. Laying in bed with her, the two of them tucking in early, no hanky-panky, just teeth brushing and cuddling up before falling asleep, preparing for their big day. Kimmy was snoring in no time—well, not snoring, but lightly puffing sleepy air—and he lay there thinking how he'd almost gone through with bailing on this trip to Cayman.

One side of him was explaining to himself that it was a middle finger to Devlin (Fuck you, Devlin—I'm not riding in your stupid plane to go to your stupid company's villa . . . no, your father's company . . . Out of principle alone, I turn my back on your offer). And at its face value, maybe that was a valiant move. Maybe that had merit. But he had to come to realize there were things luring him in that direction of abandoning the trip that weren't so wholesome or noble. There was something about it that made him feel a certain way. An unexpected way.

But the thing that had flipped this whole comprehension of relationships, the three-way vectors running between him and Devlin and Devlin and Kimmy and Kimmy and him were turned on its head by the realization that what kept his bond strong with his wife, with his beloved Kimmy, was the

honesty. That was what had saved them. Dishonesty was what had put them in jeopardy. And he'd engaged in dishonesty because of a sick, lurid thrill. Because he was so ashamed to share the truth with Kimmy because she would reject the arousal it presented her twisted husband.

Only, a glimmer of that truth had been revealed, and he discovered that his Kimmy wasn't so alarmed by the weird thing that nothing but bold outright honesty would make them strong as they could be. He had to divulge to her—as embarrassing as it may be—the cavalcade of truths that he'd obscured, stepped in front of them, waving his hands to block the view, saying, “Nothing to see here.”

So the plane ride had been fraught with twisting emotions. He'd just about chewed a hole in his cheek (and the grapefruit they served sure did make that sing sounds of complaint—the champagne soothed the sting). By the time the limo had taken them to the Stone Brokerage's fancy-schmancy turquoise villa with all its top-of-the-line amenities and its ocean view, he was a bundle of nerves. And he countered the nerves by saying stupid things. Looking out the window in the grand A-peaked main room with its towering mango-painted wall and its inset fireplace, looking out the window with his hands in his pockets and complaining about the view. He'd said, “Barely see the ocean.” Then: “Is it the ocean? I guess it's the bay, really, isn't it?” Taking the villa down a peg or two. Then the more bizarre concepts came. Wandering around saying to Kimmy, “Wonder how many secretaries Devlin's fucked on this couch.” What an ugly thing to say. And Kimmy, maintaining her smile, patient with her disgruntled husband, nodding, saying, “I don't think they always get this cottage. There're four cottages here . . .” Like that made a difference. All right, whatever number of secretaries Devlin had fucked on this estate, divide it by four, divide by the number of couches and beds in the villa, there you have your number. Kimmy was good at math, he didn't have to do that for her.

Then he was going even stranger and lower. “Probably his dad, too. His dad's a real piece of shit as well. Wonder how many times he cheated on his wife? Not that Devlin's mom was a treat by any means . . .” Kimmy still staying all smiles, the polite and professional wife. Her complacency began to irritate him. Almost as if her not joining in on his shit-kicking was

somehow approval for her boss's behavior . . . And shit, here he was, piling it on again. Making things worse. Steering his cart from the path of truth onto the rough terrain of belligerence and lies and future trouble. Then when he began with her, trying to be real and honest, it all came out too fast in a jumble of emotions, everything that had been weighing on him, everything he'd hidden from her . . .

An hour ago, this was how it began.

In the kitchen, he watched Kimmy pour two short crystal glasses of some high end whiskey, smelling the whiskey one more time before plugging the decanter closed with its jewel lid. She passed him his glass, held hers up, and they clinked them together, the crystal singing a high heavenly note that soured his disposition again. The fine things collected by those Stone men. Maybe Kimmy just another thing to add, another notch on Devlin's belt. He sipped the whiskey, and it burned. Kimmy enjoyed hers, set it down, pushed against him like she wanted to squeeze all the bitter badness out of him. That was when the emotion welled up inside him. Regret and shame, worry that his bad demeanor was ruining his wife's great gift. She'd earned this. Earned it and made sure he was there. Wouldn't take no for an answer. Told him outright she wouldn't go if he wasn't coming. And this was how he treated her. He had to give her a gift bigger than what Devlin could give. Honesty. As difficult as it may be for him, the thing he needed to do was present to her the truth. But where to begin? He started by saying, "We should talk."

Off to a terrible start. Even he knew that. We should talk sounds like there was trouble coming. But he didn't want it presented like trouble, no sir, he wanted it presented as a good thing. Here's this burden I've been caring, I'm going to release it and in releasing it, there's a hidden burden on you maybe you didn't even know you carried, but we're going to push it off your shoulders, too, and it's going to make both of us better. But it wasn't the best sentence to start with.

"Talk about what?" she'd said, and instantly she was nervous. And in that darkness of his mind, now he wondered what she was so worried about, and started imagining she was worried that he was going to talk about breaking

up, maybe putting things aside for a bit, and that made him wonder why would she think that? Was there something she was guilty for? Something weighing on her? Flashes of meanness crossed him then, and in the wake of his stupid opening statement his lips were twitching, and he couldn't help scowling.

She'd said, "Did I do something wrong?"

"Oh God, no," he'd babbled, feeling his eyes swell. The idea that her feelings would be hurt by his rudeness or brusqueness or inarticulate nature hurt his heart. "God no, Kimmy, nothing like that at all. We need to talk. I need to come clean . . ."

"What did you do?" she said, her chin dimpling.

"I didn't do anything," he said, "it's not like that. There's so much . . ." And then he was talking fast, his hand rolling and rolling, trying to hurry up his own words like now that it started he couldn't wait to get finished. "There's so much that's weighing on me, and I just keep it hidden, I let it fester inside me, I don't talk about it, I tell myself it's for your sake, that I don't want to put this burden on you, that maybe I'm imagining some of the shit, but there are things that I shouldn't hide. You're my wife and I love you, and even if these things are embarrassing to me, maybe I need to tell them to you . . ."

Though her posture softened, her features stiffened. She licked her lower lip, her brows lowered as far down as they would go. "What are you hiding from me?"

"Kimmy, again, it's not bad. It's not something bad. Not something I've done, just things that in the past I never wanted to talk about. I let them sit there in the dark, and you're forging ahead, and I'm pretending like they don't matter, but they matter . . ."

She said, "What is it?"

"I don't know how to start this," he said, now rejecting the whole idea and wishing he'd just come to the Cayman Islands, enjoyed this villa, did dirty

things with his wife in every room, defiling the couches in his own way instead of lamenting how Devlin had done it. Instead, he'd thought it was a good idea to be truthful . . .

Kimmy, reading his mind: "Be truthful, Josh, tell me the truth."

"Let's . . . Let's grab our drinks. If you don't mind—maybe something a little sunnier?"

"You don't like the whiskey?"

"Something sunnier, something fruity . . . this won't be the happiest talk, and I don't want my mouth to go dry and only have this firewater . . ."

"Is it bad?"

"The talk? I don't know if it's bad, Kimmy," he'd said, looking away. "But it's honest."

"Okay," she said, trying to make the best of it. She opened the fridge, said, "Pineapple? Rum? You want an alcoholic drink?"

"You know what—just Cokes or something easy."

"I can make things in the blender here," she said, pointing at the Vitamix and the Cuisinart gleaming on the polished counter. Was she stalling? Why would that make you mad? Why would he even think she was stalling? Now he was offended that maybe she wasn't so eager to hear his truth. Maybe his truth was only important to him. But if that were true, how low would that be? Kimmy wasn't like that . . .

He rubbed his eyes, said, "Yeah, you know what, let's make proper drinks. You don't have to have rum. I think I'd like to have rum . . ."

At least that brightened her spirits for the moment, and they worked together (though stiffly), getting frozen pineapple concentrate, rum, tequila, lemon juice, grenadine, a touch of coconut milk into the blender. Made themselves proper frosty drinks, and suddenly the proposition of what he was about to do didn't seem so bad.

But he'd forgotten the enormous weight behind the words he was going to utter.

And he'd never anticipated Kimmy's terrible response . . .

Truth

There was a path that led from the back patio, a groomed and landscaped pool in a courtyard way off on the left, a common area for all the villas to share, and they strolled along the manicured gravel between Caribbean evergreens, out on to rocky sand. He thought to complain about the beach's texture, but bit his tongue instead. There were heavy duty beach chairs there, and they each sat in one, while the waves lapped at the shore near their bare feet.

It was incredible to think of this enormous boon they were enjoying together. Incredible to think of the value of this woman at his side. This amazing, smart, funny, sensuous woman. Tall, long-legged, a brilliant mind; disciplined, hard-working, and so fucking caring. He set down his glass between his feet, rubbed his face again. He owed to her the real story.

Kimmy worked her chair closer, but failed with her light body weight, having to stand up and drag it until the armrests touched. She laughed at how the weight of the chair outclassed her, then sat down again, light and soft and feminine and receptive. He hoisted up his glass, touched hers, said, "I think I like sugary drinks better than whiskey."

"To each their own," she said, smiling, squinting against the sun. It was hazy and hot, but the colors still bright enough to make both of them slit their eyes. He took a swig, enjoyed the high octane sugar alcohol mixture. He sniffled, rubbed his hands together. She said, "Go ahead, I want to hear everything."

He shuffled his feet in the sand. "First," he said, wanting to set things straight, "I have to say . . ."

He faced her, showed her a crooked smile. She waited.

“I couldn’t be more proud of you. You earned this,” he said, gesturing a hand out to the bay. The Caribbean Sea. The ocean. It didn’t matter. It was beautiful, and someone paid her on top of her salary with this wonderful gesture of a vacation that she wouldn’t take without her husband. “You’re amazing. You’re my hero. You make me proud. Every time I walk in a room with you, I can’t wait to say that you’re the person that I came in with. People probably wouldn’t believe it. It’s not just that you’re beautiful, I know that. That’s obvious. It’s the things you can do. It’s your heart.”

Now she was sniffing, touching her eye, sniffing louder. “Thank you, Josh,” she said.

“I know how hard you work. And this is amazing that Devlin would send you here. What I’m about to tell you has nothing to do with you, with your work for Devlin, or with coming to Cayman. Okay?”

“Okay,” she said, nodding.

“You asked me once if Devlin beat me up.”

“Did he?”

“He had Johnny Rumble do it. It was worse than what I already told you. And there were some other kids, too, and I’ve forgotten their names. But that was a long time ago. Grade 6. Just jocks that he hung out with. But it was in Grade 7 that he really started taunting me.”

“I’m with you,” she said, preparing herself.

His head leaned heavily to one side, not able to look her in the eye now. “Look, he thought it would be real funny to call me gay.”

“That’s typical, right? I mean guy stuff.”

“Yeah,” he said, “but Devlin had a reason that gave it leverage.”

“What was the leverage?”

He let out an exasperated sound, rolled his eyes up to look at the sky, a pelican flying above. This was just about the best place to talk about something so stupid, but that had been so terrible for him at one time. “Like, okay . . . in Grade 7, you know, when everybody’s changing?”

Kimmy filled his pause. “In the locker room?”

“No, I mean changing, Kimmy. Changing-changing.”

“Puberty.”

“The beginnings.”

“I know about it.”

“Devlin was one of the first, okay?”

“To change. Okay.”

“And it’s not like this meant anything, but he caught me, like, a couple times in the shower—”

“Oh.”

“I don’t know what you mean by ‘oh.’”

She turned up her nose.

“Not like jerking off or anything, you know, like . . .”

“What were you doing?—Like, looking . . .?” She furrowed her eyebrows, and it made him smile despite the chagrin.

“Right. But just because I wasn’t changing yet. And don’t get me . . . don’t get it wrong, it’s not like I’m the only guy Devlin did this to. It’s not like I was some lone creep who was in the shower and I couldn’t wait to check him out.”

“I don’t think you would be like that.”

“Well, given the things I’ve been saying recently . . .”

“It’s all part and parcel, Josh. I think I got it without having to get it. And I don’t think you were like that—lecherous, checking him out—I wouldn’t believe that for a second. None of what you’re saying surprises me.”

“Well, thank you,” he said, using a dramatic tone for comedic effect. “But, like, Devlin’s body was changing and mine wasn’t yet, so when I’m in the shower . . .”

“You’re looking over to see what other boys have going on.”

“Right, but Devlin’s an asshole—I don’t know if you know that.”

“You’ve told me.”

“But you know he is,” he chided good naturedly.

“He’s not always the nicest person.”

He grumbled, her response bothering him for some reason. He said, “Anyway, Devlin was pretty pleased with his body’s early progress, if you know what I’m saying.”

“I know. It’s not dissimilar for girls.”

“And so he had no problems flaunting it. It. Practically making you look—you know I’m saying?”

“I do.”

“But then, when you would look, he would scold you for it. Get everybody to join in, and then . . . humiliate you. Right? Like, taunt what you have, and when you’re that age, that’s a lot to have to take.”

“It sure is, Josh,” she said, being sympathetic, showing him a soft and caring wifely face that he liked to see.

It was awkward and uncomfortable to reveal to your wife one of the weirdest and probably most damaging aspects of your youth. A secret you'd kept hidden. Even from yourself it'd been hidden for a long time. That weird moment of adolescent envy—of raw penile covetousness—had forged a future for him dictated by bully Devlin and his ilk. Forever the inferior. Forever the lesser. He was put on his heels by it. So afraid of being called gay in front of other boys—or worse, maybe, girls—that he'd shied away from most social interaction, lest one of Devlin and his crew show up and refer to him as Devlin's girlfriend. Being gay wasn't even the problem. There were guys who were gay in their class. It was this strange feeling of being secretly closeted. Like he was almost embarrassed denying he was gay. Like some of the other students pitied him because he didn't have the courage to come out. But he wasn't gay. And it situated him in this dark but shallow place he had trouble hiding in. And that was all he wanted sometimes was just a good place to hide.

He told her all of this, laughing as he went along to alleviate any discomfort Kimmy might feel hearing her husband's truths being divulged. She chuckled with him, but was polite. He finalized his description of Devlin's homosexual framing of his youth by saying: "Yet here I am on a beach with the woman I love. If you told me any day I might spill to someone my tortured guts, the last place I figured I'd be doing it is on a beautiful beach in the Caribbean. I figured more like some dismal couch in some doctor's office, some office in a medical complex in Scarborough.

"You're welcome," she said. It was pleasant, but he couldn't help feeling put in his place. It was indeed her doing, her abilities bringing them to this perfect locale. He should be grateful—yet he couldn't escape sensing a certain unworthiness.

But her beautiful and supportive face reminded him not to be so dark. "Or that I'd be telling it to someone who mattered. Someone I'd be so lucky to have."

"Josh," she said, frowning, "I'm lucky to have you. We're lucky to have each other. Stop putting me on a high pedestal. You've really been doing that a lot lately."

“You’re changing.”

“No, I’m not.”

“Sure you are. I like it. You’re finding yourself. I loved who you were, but I also am pretty crazy about this new Kimmy too.”

“That’s sweet—but I’m not changing, baby.”

“Well, anyway,” he chuckled, looking out at the horizon, honestly smiling. Honestly feeling lighter. “That’s the bedrock of my position with Devlin Stone. He bullied the shit out of me. Called me gay. Wagged his junk at me, made fun of mine . . .”

“Yours is fine, Josh.”

He slumped. “I know it’s fine. Sometimes you feel like fine isn’t good enough. Sometimes you’re not sure what fine really is.”

“You’re fine,” she said sternly.

“Yeah, but . . .”

“But what?”

“What do you know about it?”

She laughed, scowling, smiling, trying to figure his meaning. “What do you mean, what do I know about it?”

He had trouble articulating, not wanting to be insulting. “It’s a compliment.”

“How?” One of her eyebrow went lower, and she looked ready for friendly conflict.

“You’re not a penis expert.”

“I didn’t get my degree in penis, no.”

“You’re cute,” he said, watching her fold her arms over her narrow chest, sunlight drawing a fat luscious line of pastel along the edge of her collarbone.

“It doesn’t matter what I know. Devlin made fun of you when you were a kid, and then you grew up. I quite like what you’ve got.”

“Quite?”

Her humor faded, and she said seriously. “I love what you’ve got.”

“That’s your marital duty,” he sighed.

“I’ve . . . you’re not my . . .”

“I know I’m not your first,” he finished.

“And you’re not any different.”

“Maybe I just want to be different and . . .”

“You really do covet.”

“I guess I do.”

“That’s your problem,” she said sarcastically.

“Devlin put it in my head that what he’s got means everything, and now it’s ingrained.”

She said, “It’s not everything.”

“But it’s something.”

She rolled her eyes. “Josh, Devlin Stone is a man very focused on the things he has. You think I don’t know it? He can’t go ten minutes without letting you know about something he’s got. Something he’s going to get. Who cares if he has a huge dick?”

Hearing his wife utter those words hit him unexpectedly. So vulgar, so crude. So unlike gentle Kimmy. His heart pounded harder, his neck tightened. He had trouble swallowing for a moment. “You think it was huge?”

Now she rolled her eyes higher, tightened her folded arms. “Oh, come on, Josh, don’t do that to me.”

The mission wasn’t to go after her. Going after her was a sign of something else. Also a sign of that same something else: he’d gotten hard while talking to her about his dick compared to Devlin’s. “I’m kidding,” he said, then for some inexplicable reason: “I mean it is huge, I just mean, you know . . .”

“I know,” she said.

Know what?—that Devlin’s dick is huge. Now he was winding his neck around in his shirt collar, feeling stifled despite the lovely breeze coming off the ocean. The bay. “This makes me so uncomfortable.”

“You don’t have to do this if you don’t want, Josh.”

“Don’t you want to hear this?”

“Of course, baby,” she said, rubbing his arm. “But not if it’s too tough for you.”

“I’d like it more if you needed to hear the truth from me.”

“Okay, I do need to,” she said, meeting his eye, nodding. Ready to tell him anything he wanted to hear.

This was so tough because the next part was the doozy.

Confession

When he was a boy, Devlin showed off what was growing between his legs, and Josh'd been curious. Totally normal. Devlin had bullied Josh, catching him looking. Pretty straightforward. Josh told her how Devlin taunted his smaller penis size. She was unprepared to hear him reveal it, surprised by the candor, then disappointed he wasn't more forthcoming. She knew Devlin and his friends had called Josh Double-A, though Josh didn't know she knew that.

But maybe Josh wasn't ashamed to tell her more details, just had to leave some of them out to keep his story moving, or maybe he'd even forgotten what they'd called him. Though she doubted that—Josh wouldn't forget something like that. Not Josh. Being taunted for your penis size must be punishing. She'd been taunted as well; called flat-chested by some girls she didn't like. Not having big breasts was hard for a while—she got Josh's covetousness—but somehow, as she matured, she knew big breasts weren't coming. Knew what to expect in her development. Josh maybe kept hoping every night that when he'd wake, his little thing had grown larger. He probably wouldn't be able to anticipate what his development would be like, but had seen what Devlin Stone had and probably wished his would be like that. She could get that, sympathize with it.

Then Josh is entering phase two of his tale, the sun beginning to sink toward the horizon. Phase two is more menacing. The entry of Johnny Rumble and some of Devlin's other aggressors. There's what happened that night after the dance where Johnny Rumble punched him in the stomach and removed his jacket. Josh tells her Karina was there, and it made her wonder why Karina wasn't in the story the first time Josh had told it. A newfound memory or a purposeful misremember? Josh tells her of the

shame he felt. The hurt. And when he'd first told her a week ago, she was inclined to remove Devlin from the lever of force. It wasn't Devlin who punched Josh. That was all true and meaningful, Devlin wasn't really at fault, but Josh's pain should have been her primary concern originally. Instead, she'd centered on absolving Devlin. Whether Josh would admit it was Johnny Rumble's discretion or not, the point was her husband had attached Devlin to that awful event permanently, so she would not challenge it. All that mattered was Devlin was part of Josh's torment. Perceived or not, Devlin made Josh's life more difficult. It was truly impressive that her Josh could have been so strong to begin with, not defying her interest in taking on a job offered by Devlin. When she wondered if she could, Josh was supportive (but slung around sarcasm). Didn't stop her. It must have driven him mad, knowing now all the blackness he held in his heart for her new boss. Josh had gritted his teeth and endured. That had her reaching out and running her hand on his back while he still spoke, knees on elbows, leaned forward in the heavy lounge chair. They'd sunk into the rocky beach they'd sat there so long. They should make more drinks.

Then Josh tells her about the party at Tiffany's and her heart's beginning to beat faster, and she's worried where this will go. Does Josh know the truth, and he wants to face it with her? Maybe that wouldn't be terrible. How terrible could it be if he's still sitting here at her side? For a second she could picture Josh holding her hands and saying he could forgive her, but if only she left Stone Brokerage . . .

But his story is not about what someone told him had happened at Tiffany's. No, his story's about a dream he had. Saying maybe it wasn't a dream, maybe it was real. Then, tears in his eyes, saying no, it was definitely a dream. She asked him about the dream, either her hand shaking on his back, or his back shaking under her palm. He can barely tell her. He's ashamed. Embarrassed. But Josh was right. She needed to hear. Josh says he woke up with Devlin in his tent. Devlin says he fucked her. Now it's definitely her hand trembling. She says it's ridiculous and Josh agrees. "I know it is," he says. "It was very real to me."

"Why would he say that?"

“He’d think it was funny. He’d know it would hurt me, and that would be the part that was funny.”

“He’s not like that,” she said, and then winced.

Josh was mad, exhaling, shaking his head. Her hand still smoothed. He thumbed a hard circle on his palm. She thought of when Devlin could have done that. But he didn’t. It was stupid. Ludicrous.

“So you had a crazy dream,” she said.

“In my dream . . . Devlin said . . .”

Now her fingers went cold. Knew this was going to get worse.

He put his hands over his face, thumbs along his jawline, pinkies pressed together, like he was praying into his hands. “Devlin said I asked him to do it.”

It wasn’t what she’d expected—nowhere near as bad. Almost a letdown after the heights of the story’s beginning. She’d been almost terrorized, waiting to hear what Josh knew. What this possibly-real Devlin had told him inside their tent.

Josh let it soak in for a second and she didn’t know how to take it. She’d been expecting much worse—and what he’d said now made it all the more likely he’d dreamt this. Then Josh was quick with a follow up: “Which is why I think it was a dream. Because there’s no way I’d say that to him. No way that I’d even think that, so . . .”

She rubbed his back still, mind racing.

“It’s just a dream, Josh.”

Now he peeped her way, and she tried to smile, though her neck and face muscles felt too tight to work.

“He said you guys had sex at Tiffany’s party while I was sleeping. While I was drunk. That you kept getting interrupted . . .” He’d tried to keep her

eyes, but weakened and had to look away. Which was a relief because it took every bit of control not to crumble. Dream Devlin had told him the truth. Could Devlin really do that? Josh wanted to say more, but all she wanted to do right now was storm back to the villa and call Devlin. Demand the truth.

Josh was trying to make sense of his story still. “Maybe I imagined it, maybe I knew something, saw something, and then my dream became . . .”

“Saw what?”

“You two. Maybe Devlin messing with you.”

“And you mean you were drunk?”

“Like hazy. I saw it and maybe . . . because you didn’t have . . . you didn’t with Devlin . . .?”

The proper reaction would be anger. He’d just questioned her fidelity. An innocent wife would be furious. But she had cheated. Or at least almost cheated. But even an innocent wife would also recognize her husband’s torment and maybe not want to fight. She didn’t know how to react.

“Josh, I told you what happened.” Her mouth was sticky dry. Every thought she had sought to rectify Josh’s dream with reality. Had he seen something? Maybe he’d seen something and then dreamed the rest. It was more likely than Devlin confronting him. But then . . . Devlin definitely got off on being the outside man, giving Josh’s wife the big huge cock he knew Josh didn’t have . . .

Josh groaned and slumped. “I know, I know. I told myself I was crazy, but then the text I got . . .”

Was the text real or a fabrication? For the first time in a week she could entertain again the idea that Josh’s unfounded claim of a nasty text from Devlin was true. But she’d sequestered that idea, relegated it to the box of notions that Josh was having second thoughts about her working for Devlin, and his worries had riled an anxiety in him that made up some falsity that

Devlin had taunted him. Or that Josh had been testing her. Pretty vain thought . . . and then from those twists came a clarity: She could see Amy in her mind's eye that night at Tiffany's. The two of them tittering, enjoying seeing each other again after a long break. Amy's helping her get Josh to bed, but Josh is drunk and they have to walk him. Josh has to pee. She pulls out his penis—Amy's not supposed to be looking—and finds Josh has an erection. She has difficulty aiming his erection so he wouldn't get pee on himself or on her. Amy takes a peep. Then proceeds to make fun of Josh's penis. Lamenting his small size. Paired with a new knowledge that maybe Amy's relationship with Devlin had been damaged by her inability to procure a third for their bed, she could see a path now where Devlin was right: Amy could have sent the text. Devlin said she was a psycho.

Josh was still going: "And it said he was at Harbor 60 and—"

"Who?"

He looked cross at her, like she hadn't been paying attention. Maybe she hadn't. "Devlin."

"The text?"

"He said he was at Harbor 60 and he fingered you—"

"At Harbor 60?"

"At our apartment, Kimmy." Josh scowled.

Now her scalp tingled, Devlin had fingered her in their apartment. The day he'd suggested a job opportunity. "What else did it say?"

"That he came by the apartment and he and you messed around. That he left me a card in the front hall to prove it."

"That's crazy," she said, whispering in incredulity.

"But it happened."

The blood drained from her face and she cupped a hand over her mouth, eyes boring into the sheets of crystal water cascading in slow pulses up the rocky beach near their feet. “But that’s not true.”

“Why would he send me that?”

“Why would you never tell me that? Why would you . . .” Why would he ever let her work for Devlin if he believed this was true? How could he do that?

Now his eyes got teary again. He was ashamed.

“Why, Josh?”

“I don’t . . . I don’t want to get in your way of a good thing.”

“But if he texted we were messing around . . .”

“I don’t believe it for a second,” he said, firm, jaw muscles flexing.

Seeing his defiance in the face of awful taunting—all because of how he believed in her—riled her heart. Reminded her why she fell in love with the guy in the first place. She ran her hand on his back again, going in big circles. “None of it was true, Josh, and I don’t think . . .”

“It’s not true, but his intent—”

“I don’t even think it’s him, Josh.”

It was supposed to be good news, but instead Josh blanched and his expression deflated. She could see in his eyes—an immediate response—that he’d been wounded.

Quiet, he said, “Of course you’d fucking say that.”

“What—why, Josh? . . .”

He shrugged away from her hand, stood and walked to put his feet in the water. “I can’t believe you’d defend him.”

“I’m not . . .”

“You’d let him do anything.”

“That’s stupid, Josh, don’t say that, I’m not . . .”

“Right, stupid,” he said, bucking for a fight. She shut up. He shook his head, then didn’t know what to do anymore. Then he hiked around and walked behind his chair, heading up the small beach to the path.

“Hey, Josh, don’t . . .” She called after him: “I just mean it might’ve been Amy.”

But Josh wasn’t hearing, disappearing now under the canopy of small trees and evergreens.

She crossed her arms, crossed a leg, shaking her head at him and grinding her teeth. How would she explain the thing with Amy if she didn’t say she’d talked to Devlin about this?

At last, the bedroom door unlatched, and she rose from the back of the chair she’d been sitting on. Josh looked at her sheepishly from the open bedroom doorway, scratching the back of his head. “I’m an asshole.”

She said, “No, you’re not. I could’ve been more careful. More supportive.”

“You were supportive. I let Devlin manipulate my actions again.”

“You let me know some of the hardest things you endured as a kid and I was careless.”

“You endured worse than me, and I feel selfish.”

“My mom?” She shrugged. “Everyone’s got their baggage.”

Josh said, “I’m not special.” Magnanimous and far-seeing. Another reason she’d always had a crush on him.

“Still . . . I won’t defend Devlin anymore,” she assured him.

“Do what you need to do. I’m a big boy.”

“Can you come here?” She put out her arms at waist height. Josh came to her, and they embraced. Near his ear, she said, “We can go home if you want. If you think this place is Devlin’s . . .”

“No, it’s ours,” he said. “I want to be here with you.”

“I want to be here, too,” she said, snaking her arms around him tighter.

“I’m glad I told you those things,” he said.

“Me too. And I love your perfect dick.” He stiffened, and she chuckled, hugged him harder till he relaxed. “I mean it.”

“I know you do.”

It felt good to be in his arms. Felt good to be away from home and in this amazing paradise with him. She hadn’t been kidding. All she wanted to do was couples stuff. Devlin gave her what she wanted on Wednesday, fucking her good on his new bed. But this was how she wanted to spend her weekend. With her buddy. Her husband. Though not like this. Not with this existential weight on them still. Maybe it’d be a blessing he’d divulged his hurt to her.

But she’d have to explain the thing about Amy. Explain it before her husband’s dark and anxious mind began to work on the reasons why she’d defend Devlin and try to foist the text on her friend.

“Baby, can I explain about Amy? . . .”

II

Saturday, August 15

Hell

Josh had been to hell and back. Literally.

Now he was on the villa's back patio, reclining on a sunbed, the things he'd purchased in Hell arranged on his bare chest.

Since Kimmy had her meeting this morning with Stone Brokerage's Cayman Islands lawyer—he was pretty sure what that would indicate—his sweet and loving wife had arranged for him a way to pass the time while she was engaged with work. A thing that she wouldn't have done with him, or at least could have spared missing while she was in Grand Cayman, arranging for a car to pick him up and take him out sightseeing. The villa had a rental car, and Kimmy had taken that into George Town. This afternoon, the two of them were going to a museum, then they were going to the beach, then they were going to have an awesome dinner by candlelight.

But this morning his wife had sent him to Hell.

Hell was a geological formation up here in the West Bay. A terrible burned out geosphere that looked ravaged and ruined by hellfire. Truth was it was just a limestone field, but a special kind of algae coats it, the algae goes black and spurred, and generally looks quite frightening—but a good story sells.

Tourists aren't allowed to go and walk on the jagged rocks, but you could walk the perimeter, admire the hellish spectacle. He'd spent over an hour in Hell, but most of it was touring the shops. Hell had an official post office there, and he'd sent postcards to his family. Even one to Meyer and Sophie, hoping Sophie wouldn't be frightened by the nightmarish postcard arriving

from Hell. On that postcard he refrained from signing off as Satan. There was a gift shop filled with all sorts of satanic double entendres and it was there he had a veritable field day.

Hell's gift shop was a wood shack painted vibrant burning red. A sign over yellow painted flames said Welcome to Hell on the side. Of all the things Kimmy could have found for him to do in Grand Cayman, she picked the most perfect thing for his solo time. She knew him well.

So in the gift shop, he bought himself a T-shirt, Kimmy a T-shirt, T-shirts for Sophie and Meyer, and some other devilish trinkets. But on his chest now there were globs of polished obsidian. Hell, Grand Cayman was a geological destination. And while the obsidian wasn't from here (the shopkeeper told him it was from Brazil), it did fit the theme of the location. On its gold chain, he strung up now the necklace he'd bought for Kimmy. The pendant was a gleaming but un-smooth hunk of obsidian, almond-shaped, with a natural bright red dot imperfection in its belly. The little note card on the jewelry case called it The Devil's All-Seeing Eye. It was \$175, but there was no way he wasn't buying it. The young lady at the counter still ran her sales pitch, putting the necklace on herself, showing how the pendant was smoothed on one side so it sat flat against her chest, the red pupil looking outward, all-seeing. He told her he was already buying it and she didn't have to work so hard, laughing, and she wrapped it up and put in a box. But when he got home, he couldn't wait to look at it again. So now here he was, laying here and waiting, aching for Kimmy to return home.

Whenever he'd pictured ever revealing all the things he'd revealed last night to somebody—though he never imagined he really would—he wondered if he would feel better in the aftermath. He'd divulged 95% of his suffering to his wife last night. But she'd somehow trumped him.

Not that her story was worse, but that there he was spilling it all out and he'd never anticipated the love of his life would also have been put under thumb so terribly by Devlin. Only Kimmy didn't see it that way. He didn't confront her on it, but wasn't that what it was? Wasn't she also bullied?

The worst part for him was the inescapable thoughts of what she told him. The dirty thoughts. The thoughts that shouldn't be happening. The worst

thing he could do was sexualize Kimmy's suffering. But how could he not be aroused by some of those thoughts? Amy tricking Kimmy into coming to Devlin's house, bringing her down into his big superstar basement. Probably with a home gym and a sauna and a big home theater or some shit, Kimmy all timid. Then the real reason they tricked her there. Join us in a threesome. Now as he was looking into this devilish eye, hearing some Hammer movie occult chant: "One with us, one with us, one with us . . ."

And his Kimmy had fled.

Kimmy Chang in high school was a very different Kimmy Chang than the one he married. Also, the Kimmy Chang he'd married was quite different from the Kimmy Chang who'd earned this Grand Cayman treat. There were many facets to his wife, and he was watching her discover them. But Kimmy in high school was a parents' dream. A perfect kid. Anything less than 100% on a test or report card was complete and abject failure. Extra-curricular's up the wazoo. Smart, gracious, and decent. And Josh Waters had kissed her. And there was something there. Then . . . she went to Taiwan; she came back, that strange elusive thing they had hid from them both. He was afraid to approach her again. At least in that way that allowed their mouths to come together. They'd sat close a few times, and he'd ached to lean near her and try to get it going again. But he chickened out big time. When she came back from Taiwan that time, she was quite different. Tragedy struck. She was dealing with her mother. Though, like a good citizen, she didn't burden her peers. But he heard through friends what was going on at home. Plus, Kimmy was hanging out a lot more with Amy back then. And Amy was starting to show those signs of a girl that was taking leaps and bounds after puberty. Amy was smart. Amy tutored a lot of Devlin's friends. But she wasn't a good citizen like Kimmy was. Amy had tried to corrupt her good friend all in the name of pleasing her Lord and Master, Devlin Stone. A teenage Devlin Stone, just finding his footing at being the demon he was now. He could picture Kimmy heading over to Devlin's house to hang with Amy and Devlin. Amy was all super-amped in those days about being seen with Devlin. About being on his arm and maybe possibly being his girlfriend. It never worked out that way. So Devlin had put the pressure on Amy, finding his perfect foil. Josh could see

it now. Amy was perfect. She was a manipulator, and also a person who desired things. And would go to any length, he imagined, to obtain those things she desired. Devlin had told Amy what he wanted, and Amy procured it. I'll get us a girl we can play in bed with. This timid straight-A student with barrettes in her hair, probably showing up at his basement that night in pressed khakis, and a buttoned up shirt. Hi guys, what's going on? All innocent. Then they spring it on her. Assholes.

The thing his wife and told him last night he hadn't seen coming. All he'd wanted to do was unburden himself from the things that were weighing him down. Give to his wife a perspective that she didn't have because he'd hid it from her. Two things. Free himself. Inform his wife. He and Kimmy were on the same side. And Kimmy had listened. He held back, gave her what she needed to hear, but refrained from some of the gory details. This didn't need to be snuff. X-rated was fine. Hell, R-rated. When she'd offered up a defense of Devlin, telling him it was probably Amy, he'd never been more deflated. Let down.

The way his mind worked, Kimmy was defending Devlin yet again. But when she broke down, God, almost crying, telling him about this horrid, shameful moment she'd been subjected to, he could see it from her side. They had to be in this together. They had to work as a team. But dammit, that devilish part he had hiding in himself wouldn't stop thinking about that threesome. What if she was lying to you? What if she climbed into bed with Devlin and Amy? Maybe she was just too afraid to tell you that part. Now thinking of her rolling around in bed, all three of them naked, exploring each other's bodies.

He was the lowest of the low for the erection that thought provoked. But it was there. He handled it over his shorts now, chewing his cheek and wishing he wasn't such a pervert.

But there he had it—right there in Kimmy's past was an opportunity for her to do the thing he feared (and feared that he wanted), sleeping with Devlin. It had been presented to her, and she'd run in the other direction like a good girl. That was the truth. As much as he'd like to fantasize about his wife as a teen, writhing in bed with some nefarious but definitely very hot partners, that wasn't the truth.

And look at Kimmy, look how she was able to get past the things that happened to her. Despite that stabbing wound in her past, she was able to work with the stabber. Able to put all that behind her, compartmentalizing, and move forward. How many times did she have to tell her husband that despite how terrible it was having to work for a horrible person she didn't respect and who was an asshole, she was doing it for them as a couple? A hundred times?—because she'd said it maybe twenty times. He hadn't been listening. Maybe the best thing he could have done was tell her the truth last night.

One thing was for sure, and he did determine this in his mind: when they got back to Toronto, he would definitely call Devlin and arrange to meet him. He would look Devlin in the eye and tell him to stop. This wasn't high school anymore, and whatever game he thought he was playing, it was time to end it. No more texts, no more nonsense. Both of us are grown-ups now. And if that jeopardized Kimmy's job, so be it. But he'd tell Devlin both of them knew how valuable Kimmy was to his business, and that if he wanted to keep that value, he would change his game. Because Kimmy was on his side. For too long, he'd separated himself, made himself an outsider. Maybe to protect her. And, yes, maybe so he could cherish some strange and new feelings. But that was over. He was sharing those strange new feelings with Kimmy, and now Kimmy knew the truth. Yes, he fucked up. There were things he knew beforehand that should have prompted him to intercept her employment with Devlin. Or at least presented to her as a huge barrier. But he hadn't. And, last night, without his prompting, Kimmy had interpreted those actions of his as nobility. And he took that on. Made that his truth now. Forget all that dark stuff about getting off on the idea of Kimmy with Devlin. Truth was he loved that woman more than anything. And the idea that he would step in her way hurt him. So he hadn't. In fact, maybe his nobility was so strong, the need to step aside from Kimmy's path provoked a feeling within him that allowed him to enjoy some dark pleasure. It wasn't the dark pleasure that had him allowing her to take the job. It was letting her take the job that had provoked the pleasure. It was important to keep this straight in his mind. So, first thing Monday morning—

Now there was a car door slamming from out front of the villa, and he was sitting up quick, letting the hot rocks fall from his chest and into his waiting

hands. He set them aside, shrugged on his wicked 1970s looking concert T-shirt. Black with white baseball sleeves, red letters on the front saying: I WENT TO HELL AND ALL I GOT WAS THIS LOUSY T-SHIRT.

Underneath that: Grand Cayman. In his hand, he held one in size extra small.

Now he hustled through the villa, hot sticky bare feet squeaking on air-conditioned tile, the weight of the devil's eye bouncing in his pocket and banging his testicles. He slowed his pace, flicked open Kimmy's shirt, holding it by the shoulders so he could show it to her as she walked up from the rental.

In the open doorway, he stood smiling, seeing his wife now standing beside the white BMW crossover. Her back was to him. She stood at the passenger side of the car. Someone else was in the car, getting out now. It was Devlin Stone, standing up on the driver side, saying something to Kimmy, both of them laughing.

Devlin closed the car door, and their eyes met. No wave, no smile. Devlin looked to Kimmy and nodded his head toward the front door. Kimmy turned, and he saw that look on her face that he knew so well. All pleasant smiles upfront, but he could measure in those dark pupils her tension. But how on earth had this happened? How did she leave here three hours ago, in Grand Cayman, and return now with the guy they'd fought and cried about last night?

Everything in him sunk, his heart thudding low and heavy, stomach sagging into his guts. The devil's eye burned against his leg. Josh wasn't Taiwanese, not raised in an Asian family, had no ability to manufacture a face with joy and grace. His emotions showed. Practically scowling at Kimmy now, his eyes screaming at her: How the fuck is this happening?

Both of them came around the front of the BMW and into the bluish shade of the front garden. "Hey, baby," Kimmy said, "look who I found."

It took everything in him not to say What the fuck is he doing here? But now, the closer Kimmy got to him, the more he pulled from her strength. He straightened, remembered everything he'd learned last night. So he said

what he wanted, but he said it nicely. “What the fuck are you doing here?” Even stepping forward and putting out a hand to shake. Devlin strode the distance, looming now so much taller than him, taking the offered hand, his big warm grip dwarfing his own.

“Hey, Josh, bet you’re glad to see me.”

“Ecstatic,” he said, and he found the more honest he was with this, the easier it was to smile—and appear gracious, even. Just two old pals busting balls, old high school chums giving each other the stick. But he wouldn’t dare grip Devlin’s hand too hard lest the guy return it double. Devlin nodded his chin toward Josh’s chest. “So what’s this—some band?”

Now he held up Kimmy’s shirt by the shoulder points to show her. She moved her head rearward, smiling, eyes scanning the phrase on the front. He said, “That one’s for you,” and tossed it to her.

She caught it, slung it over her shoulder, then leaned in for a kiss. “How was it?”

He kissed her in return, liking doing it right in front of Devlin, thumbing her jaw. He said, “It was the best. Thank you.”

Devlin asked what it was he’d done, and Kimmy told him. “I sent Josh to hell.”

Josh laughed with Kimmy, held her hand, swinging it between them. Devlin was outside of the joke, and boy did that feel good. He said, “Kimmy sent me to this geological formation called Hell, here on West Bay. For when she went to the meeting . . .”

Devlin raised his eyebrows and his chin up, getting it now. “You’re too good to this guy, Mrs. Chang.”

Waters was on his lips, but he bit his tongue.

Kimmy said, “Devlin just came for part of the meeting.”

Josh said, “Why didn’t you fly in on the plane with us?”

“I wasn’t really here for the meeting, I’m here for a different meeting. But since I was in the neighborhood, I swung by Rathburn’s office.”

“What was the other meeting?”

“I had to go . . . Long story—a bank and a different lawyer. Don’t want to bore you.”

“That’s all right.”

Kimmy said, “I told Devlin to come by for a drink,” then she said to Devlin, “Josh and I are spending the afternoon together. He’s taking me out to dinner,” looping her arm under his. The two of them side-by-side.

“Good,” Devlin said. “I really don’t want to bug you. Kimmy practically made me come.”

Kimmy scoffed. “I didn’t make you come.”

The double entendre had his stomach fluttering. He said to Kimmy, “How was the meeting?”

“It was just formality,” she said, “I went through simple paperwork. It’s all just to put my name on the logs, make sure that I came here and spoke to Rathburn. It’s all for this,” she said, opening up her palms like it was raining, looking at beautiful Cayman all around them. Right. The perk. Tax avoidance. Audit preparedness. All the methods of a guy who had two lawyers and a bank in Cayman.

“Anyway,” Devlin said, raising his left hand holding a bundle of folded fabric. “Kimmy said we’d go for a swim. I brought my things.”

Josh said, “You brought your things to the lawyer’s office?”

Kimmy said, “No . . .”

Devlin looked him in the eye and said, “We swung past my hotel room before we got here.”

Arrival

Quinton Rathburn, Stone's Cayman lawyer, had an office in a modest-sized two-story plantation house in a small enclave north of George Town. Painted all white, with wraparound two-story porches, it was buffered from the roadside by lush bountiful gardens full of brightly colored flowers. Along the side of the building there was a small parking lot, and on a Saturday there were only three cars parked there under towering palms, Kimmy's rental BMW included. The law offices were closed on weekends, except for special circumstances. Circumstances like Devlin Stone.

There was no one at reception when she entered the building, but Rathburn met her in the hall. He was a man in his late 50s and enormous. Huge and almost toad-like, but well-dressed; he spoke with a cultured Trinidadian accent, and when they were sitting at last, she noticed his open hands were larger than an 8.5x11 size piece of paper. He had the biggest hands she'd ever seen.

But before she'd entered the foyer, she'd sent a text to Amy.

Kimmy: we need to talk

Then when that seemed too dire . . .

Kimmy: some crazy news!

It would be almost evening if Amy were in London right now, so she wasn't sure if she would get a prompt response on a Saturday, or if Amy was somewhere in the world where it was bedtime. But she hoped the message would be alluring enough to get Amy interested. It did. And it was just as she and Rathburn sat at his massive walnut desk that her phone deigned and she saw Amy's response.

Amy: you need to tell me!

Kimmy: in meeting-call soon

The meeting with Rathburn was meaningless. The man showed her an outline of accounts and transactions that had transpired in the last year, some organization structures, some holdings . . . It didn't amount to anything, and she got the distinct impression that there were things withheld from her, anyway. It's not like she was given the full picture. Rathburn was polite and pleasant in his gravelly low voice, but he was disinterested. The only thing getting the big man into the office on a Saturday was all the money probably going his way from Stone Brokerage over the years. In fact, the meeting only went twenty-five minutes before he laced his fingers on his stomach, leaning back in his chair and looking over his steel frame glasses. "Do you think you have any questions?"

"No, I think I'm up to speed," she said, both of them knowing the game. She would be logged in now as a visitor at the Rathburn offices to prove that this trip was for the intent of business. Three days of fun and sun for a twenty-five minute meeting about nothing. "Thanks for your time," she said and shook his hand this time. Her hand disappeared in his grip, but he was gentle.

It was coming out of Rathburn's office that Amy texted her again.

Amy: Call me soon!

Kimmy: in a minute, gotta get somewhere I can sit

She strolled the office toward the lobby, waiting to see what Amy would return. Another visitor to the office entered, coming into the foyer quietly with his back to her and his head down. First thought seeing the man come in the lobby ahead of her was how tall and tanned and well-built he was, liking his head of glossy black hair—then realized with a finger-tingling start that it was Devlin—all the way here in Cayman.

She stopped cold in the circular lobby, resting her hand on a polished wood table with a bouquet on it.

Devlin smiled, said, “Gosh, what are you doing here, Kimberly?”

“Devlin, what the hell?”

He let the door clack behind him, rested his back on it, bit on his lower lip, then smiled. He wore charcoal cotton shorts without pockets, a black cotton polo shirt. The shirt cuffed under the slabs of his chest muscles. His legs looked tanned and hairy, feet in dove gray espadrilles. The shape of him in silhouette looked very dark against the white painted door. He looked like he lived in the Caribbean, and while she was mad at him for being here, there was a thrill that raced her right now.

She said, “I told you I wanted to be alone this weekend.”

“You can be alone,” he said. “Don't let me get in your way.”

“Oh—so you're just here for a meeting with Rathburn?”

Eyebrows raised, unbothered, he said, “I have my own schedule. Maybe it’s nothing to do with you being here.”

“It’s just a coincidence we run into each other 2500 kilometers from home, coming out the door at the exact end of my meeting you sent me here for?”

“What if I’ve got Rathburn’s 11:30?”

She chuckled, harrumphed, jabbed a thumb over her shoulder. “Then you better get in there, don’t keep the man waiting.”

He smiled, eyes narrowing, saying, “My 11:30’s with Kimmy Chang.”

“Kimmy Chang,” she said, “is Kimmy Waters this weekend. I came with Josh.”

“Now you can come with me.”

She shifted where she stood, feeling her thighs tighten. The resolve she had to stand up to him—to defy him—dissipated. The things Josh had told her last night were terrible. Devlin Stone had really twisted her husband up. Josh couldn’t see how much he did on his own—how he harmed himself. He liked to hang the weight of it around Devlin’s neck.

She asked: “Where are you staying?”

“You want to get right to it?”

“Going to your hotel room?—no, I just was hoping Josh and I aren’t going to see you around the villa.”

“Don’t worry, I’m not on the estate,” he said, hefting himself off the closed doors and strolling toward her with a confident smile.

She said, “That meeting was a waste of my time.”

“That meeting was why you’re in Cayman, kicking back with that limp husband you love so much.”

“I miss him already.”

He closed the distance between them completely, and she had to look up to meet his gaze.

He sneered, said, “I get despondent too.”

“You miss me?”

His hands caressed her hips, moving downward along her thighs, his mouth coming closer. She pooched out her lips, and their mouths connected while his hands went lower, the right hand tugging at the hem of her skirt before shoving right up underneath. She hissed into his kiss, went to her tiptoes, shot a look over her shoulder in case Rathburn caught them together in his foyer.

Devlin growled, “This is what I miss, this tight pussy,” his hand caressing over the silk of her panties.

“We had sex on Wednesday,” she said, whispering, eyes still gazing down the hall to Rathburn’s office.

“You know how good it is, Chang, know I can’t wait for you to get back to Toronto. I came all this way for this . . .”

Now his fingers found the cleft of her sex, dividing it, stroking the sensitive center of her panty-covered sex. She trembled, felt her legs begin to quiver. She said, “Where’s your hotel?”

His other hand held her by the neck, and he kissed her hungrily. The fingers scooted up, dipped down the front of her panties, dove through the tangle of her pubic hair and stroked her seam, then slipped inside her with wet ease. “Fuck,” he growled, “you are always so wet.”

“We don’t have a lot of time,” she said.

With two fingers inside her, and his hand gripping her neck, he walked her aside, away from the flower bouquet in the center of the room, off to a door next to the entranceway. He nudged it with his knee and they both stumbled

in, kissing and feeling each other, Devlin fingering her. He kicked the door shut.

“What are you doing?” she asked him as her eyes roamed around.

They were in a small personal public washroom. Wood-paneled and beautifully kept, toilet and sink gleaming, faucet sparkling, it smelled like lemons and there were luxury magazines and expensive soaps and lotions, and a glass lantern that hung over the mirror above the sink. Devlin’s hand was fondling the bulge in his shorts. It had grown while they kissed and seeing it through his pants had her aching for it.

She sighed, “I can’t believe you came all this way,” as he nibbled on her neck.

“Neither can I. I told myself I could wait till Monday, but I was so wrong . . .”

“You just need this pussy,” she said, beginning to scroll upward the front of her skirt, revealing her thighs.

“You don’t know how bad,” he said, lunging for her kiss again, taking her, wheeling her around until she faced the sink. He pulled her skirt up from the back now, gathered it up around her waist. He tugged down her panties, and she watched him in the mirror, watched his determined face as he stripped her bare, exposed her hungry sex, unzipped his huge cock and got in position. Fumbled in his pocket now, and there was a squirting flatulent sound. He stroked her pussy and up to her anus, set down in the sink basin a small tube of opened lubricant. He slid inside her with ease. She was wet, oh-so-wet for him and ready, but with the lube it was absolute heaven. He was so massive, yet she’d become accustomed to accepting him. The stretch was incredible, the feeling of tearing, the feeling of it being too much, just a small fleeting second. “Deeper,” she said, “I want you in me . . .”

“That’s my Kimmy,” he said, gripping her haunches, his fingers curling around, pinched at hipbones. He pushed himself in and out of her, and she watched what he looked like when he fucked her from behind, face very near the mirror, her breath fogging it in time with his thrusts.

“Oh, that’s so good, mm, I love it, oh, deep, mm, deep . . .”

She was up on her toes getting fucked from behind by her boss’s big cock, a bully, an asshole, her husband’s tormentor, but so hot, so fucking sexy, and the way he craved her was driving her wild. “You gonna come in me?”

“You want to feel it?”

“Come on my face.”

“Oh, fuck, Chang, fuck, you make me crazy . . .”

Now he fucked her harder, hands squeezing, thrusts wild and erratic, her pussy squelching around his size with her wet and his water-based lube. The lube was amazing—why hadn’t they used it every time?

The pressure of the pleasure built up high and astounding and her cries of passion couldn’t be quiet or contained, and she worried again about being caught, complaining, “Oh wait, oh God, easy, oh, you’re making me crazy,” in moaning pants, her clawed hand reaching back to grab his hip.

He slowed his stroke, buried and held, pulled out, went deep again.

“Oh, fuck,” she said, “you get me so loud.”

Eyes on hers in the mirror, he untied her bun, pulled and played with her hair, yanking back till his cock was buried so deep she could feel the swollen knot of his cock head like a plum in her stomach.

“Oh, oh, wow, mm,” she warbled, her brow furrowing, her reflection pinched like she was about to cry or come.

He said low: “One thing Rathburn’s good at is looking the other way. Make as much noise as you want, we won’t disturb him.”

“Yeah?”

“Fucking scream when you come, okay?”

“Yeah . . .”

Then he was going deep and long, cock head folding her labia then grinding so deep her eyes rolled up. He was growling, enjoying this unexpected big cock thrill he was giving her. “I flew three thousand miles, sitting in planes, Ubers, and airports for three hours, spent ten-grand to come fuck this tight little hole. That’s how great this pussy is Kimmy . . .”

“Yeah, yeah . . . fuck it,” she breathed.

“I know where I want to come, and it’s not in your face . . .”

“Where?”

Now he withdrew his weapon from deep inside her, gripped it, that spongy glans mushing and pressing against her asshole. She gasped, squealed and squirmed . . . but submitted.

Near her ear: “I’m going to come in your ass.” His aftershave made her wild.

Now his cockhead spread her sphincter, and she went higher on her toes, making little squeaky sounds of pain as her tightest hole was stretched wide. But once he began to enter her body, it was like her pussy was a wild and out-of-control grass fire; she felt a liquid spate flood from her interior, felt trickles of her wet rolling down the insides of her thighs.

“Yeah, you like that?”

“Mm, c-careful,” she said, eyes closed but rolled up high, electric brain activity sizzling around this crazy virgin intrusion. “No one ever fucked my ass before,” she whispered.

“Mm, fuck, Kimmy,” I love every hole you’ve got, God, you feel so fucking good . . .”

He sank deeper, but then went no further before he began to slowly thrust in and out, nice and easy. Her hand wandered down, and she reeled at the feel of how her pussy overflowed. She’d said she didn’t want him here—really

didn't—was mad that he was here, but now five minutes later she's about to come huge while he fucked her ass in his lawyer's bathroom in the Cayman Islands.

"Get yourself off," he growled, "fucking rub your clit . . ."

"Yeah," she gasped, one eye open narrow, looking at his handsome face drawn down almost like anger as he fucked her ass.

"I'm gonna come," she cried.

"I'm gonna come," he said. "Come together . . ."

"Yeah, mm, yeah, mm, I'm so close," she said, four fingers mashed down hard on her button and circling and circling and circling.

They came together. He growled then roared, she burst out a choked off cry, bit her lips, then wailed unreal pleasure as she came with his cock up her ass. She sagged against him, but it hurt and she collapsed against the sink.

Devlin pulled out his cock from her tightest aperture with an embarrassing sound, then began to beat his heavy member on her ass cheeks. "That fucking ass, Kimmy, fuck, I mean it"—he was out of breath—"it's worth every minute and dollar to get here and fuck it. You drive me so goddamn wild . . ."

Company

Both of them collapsed opposite each other, heaving breath, Kimmy on the sink, Devlin against the wall. His shorts fell around his ankles and his cock bobbed with his heartbeat, shining with the wet.

“I liked the lube,” she panted, then chuckled.

“Yeah,” he said, running his hair back from his face.

She chuckled again when neither of them could stop panting. “I’m fucking sweating,” she laughed, trying to tidy her hair.

“That was fucking hot,” he said, coming off the wall.

She didn’t want to admit it, but it was. Last thing she thought coming out of the meeting with Rathburn was that she was going to get rocked like that. It felt good to have Devlin here, as much as she hated to admit it. “I wasn’t expecting it, that’s for sure,” she said.

He came closer to her, lusty look in his eyes still, and unbuttoned her shirt. She turned her chin up and he kissed her slowly.

With her shirt open, he tugged down the cups of her bra till the hard buds of her brown nipples plopped free. He thumbed them while she watched. Her skirt still bunched at her waist and she could feel the weight of his big wet cock on her thigh, drooling. She palmed it, petted it. He groaned with satisfaction.

She said, “I’d kill for a steak and a whisky right now,” looking into his eyes.

She saw the effect; he said, “Chang, why the fuck didn’t I know you in high school? We would have banged all through university, we could run all the shipping in Ontario by now, we—”

“All I wanted was a steak,” she laughed.

“You fucking drive me crazy,” he said, putting his arms around her. “I’ll take you out tonight. We’ll get a steak, some whisky, come back to my hotel, tell Josh you’ve got another meeting with Rathburn.”

She got a hand between them to guide him back. “I told you I’m here with Josh this weekend.”

“Fucking bring him. I’ll buy us dinner and you can meet me in the bathroom and I’ll come on your face while Josh is spooning ice cream back at the table.”

She chuckled, and he joined in.

“This week,” she said. “Take me out this week. You ever go to Harbor 60?”

“Sure.”

“When was the last time you were there?”

“I don’t know. Six months, maybe. A year ago . . . I don’t remember. Why?”

“Was it good?”

“The best. That’s where you want to go, we’ll go there.”

“What did you have?”

“Don’t remember. Steak.”

She made a wily face at him. “I want a whole Porterhouse.”

“I love that you have appetites. And that I can satisfy them,” he said, circling the pad of his thumb on her erect nipple.

She covered her nipple over with the cup of her bra. “Don’t forget: You told me this was a twice a week thing, just sex. Now you’re coming all this way to be with me . . .?”

“I have to get my twice-a-week in,” he said, smiling. “Tell me you’re not happy to see me. It sure felt like it.” His eyes glanced down to her bared pussy.

“I liked the surprise, but I told you I wanted to be alone with Josh.”

“So boring,” he said, and she laughed. “Let me take you guys out for dinner tonight. For real.” Now he showed her a pleading child’s face, bowing his eyebrows and putting his hands on her waist.

“That’s crazy,” she said, snuffling. “I’m happy to see you here. I’m flattered you flew down for me. Though I’m pretty sure you have something else going on and you’re just lighting me up.”

“A hundred percent to fuck you, Kimmy, cross my heart.”

“I’m flattered,” she said, looking up to him, narrowing her eyes. He kissed her again and she let him. “Now can you give me a minute so I can clean up?”

He told her to take her time, giving her his confident look before pulling up his pants. His cock still hung out the fly, and he took a moment to wipe it with a paper towel before tucking it back in where its half-hard shape pressed out the inside of his pant leg. She caught herself admiring him for a moment, then laughed, leaning on the counter still, playing the pendant of her necklace over her lower lip. He touched her chin as he passed, and she told him she’d just be a minute as he went to the door.

“I’m going to be outside,” he said, then shut the door.

She laughed into her palms and then tidied her hair, letting out a long, slow exhale. That was crazy. Devlin was crazy.

From her purse, she withdrew her phone and woke it up. She sent a text to Amy.

Kimmy: the 'thing' finally happened

Then she went to the sink and snatched paper towels from the dispenser, wiping between her legs, pulling new sheets to wipe her brow and under her arms. Amy texted her back.

Amy: I can't believe it

She nudged the phone to read the screen, chewed her cheek for a second. Responded.

Kimmy: I can't believe it either

Then she leaned with both hands on the counter, watching for Amy's response.

Amy: I'm proud of you

Proud of her for what? For cheating on Josh?

Amy would say it was because Kimmy deserved to have sex with Devlin—just to see what it was like. How good it was. That whole thing from high school that she'd been presented but rejected, and Amy persisted after all these years that she was right in the first place. And maybe she was. Because now that she'd started, it certainly seemed that she couldn't stop. At one point even swearing she wouldn't do it, then explaining away her own bad behavior afterward.

But it should have been done before she married Josh.

Kimmy: thank you

Amy: you're welcome

Amy: tell me more

Kimmy heaved off the counter, looked at herself in the mirror. Untied her hair. She couldn't tidy it enough without starting all over. It hung down in curtains on either side of her face. She got close to the mirror and looked in her eyes. Wiggled her nose around, made pouting lips. She picked up her phone, texted.

Kimmy: it was all right

She set the phone down, turned both taps on at the sink and touched her fingers underneath until the water got lukewarm. Put both sets of fingers

under the stream then dabbled wet around her eyes, pressing on her eyebrows and finding the acupressure points.

Amy: what do you mean it was all right? Did something go wrong?

She pulled off a paper towel, pushed away the beginnings of a headache while drying over her eyes and her brow.

Kimmy: no it just wasn't what I expected

Now she shut off the hot water lever, ran the water full blast cold.

Amy: what was it like then? Wasn't it good?

She cupped handfuls of cold water then dipped her face into her palms, rubbing at her cheeks, eyes, and along her jaw. Pulled off more sheets of paper, dried her face, then looked at her reflection.

Kimmy: it was just all right. It wasn't bad or it wasn't really good

Amy: it wasn't good?

She buttoned up her shirt, watching her face in the mirror. Turned then and sat on the counter, picked up her phone.

Kimmy: it was weird. Uncomfortable. Like I said, it was all right, but it wasn't the best thing that ever happened to me

Amy: I'm surprised

Kimmy: so was I

Amy: wasn't he good to you?

Kimmy: he was great. It was actually kind of nice. But I just thought it would be better

Amy: I'm so surprised to hear that

Kimmy: I was expecting a lot more

Now she looked sideways and watched her reflection, chewing her cheek again. It really was a shame this wasn't easier, because she did like spending time with Devlin. Like spending time with him a lot. Liked fucking him, too. These were lies she was telling to Amy. Lies, because she

feared a suspicion she had. Truth was, now that she'd started with Devlin, she didn't want to stop. Truth also was, she loved Josh till the end of time. Truth was, Josh had a weird sliver in his brain sex compartment that he was embarrassed of. But he shouldn't be. Or maybe he should. She just didn't want to judge. But she did know that the things she was really doing with his high school nemesis turned him on in his fantasies.

Amy: why don't you call me?

Kimmy: can't right now. I'm at a work thing. I'm in Grand Cayman

Amy: look at you — I'm so jealous. Perks of working with Devlin?

How did she know it had anything to do with Devlin? Maybe just a good guess . . .

Kimmy: perks of being with Devlin. I'm here with Josh, but I've got work things to do. I'll call you when I get back to Toronto

Amy: call me Monday

Kimmy: I will

Amy: I miss you and I can't wait to talk to you

Kimmy: I'll call you

She closed her phone, slipped it into her purse. Then, in front of the mirror, she buttoned her shirt right up, pulled back her hair and re-tied it into a tidy style. Leaned close to the mirror, patted at her cheeks, then stood straight and eyed herself somberly. It was a terrible thing she was going to do.

With her panties straightened and her skirt fixed, she grabbed her purse and slung it over her shoulder. Pulled open the door, went into the lobby. There were sounds down the hall from Quinton Rathburn's office. The man had been here the whole time she was fucking Devlin. She crossed to the front door and slipped outside. Devlin was standing out in the sunshine, talking on his phone. Doing that pose again, one hand on his hip. He looked good from behind; he had a great body. She didn't want to stop touching it. Didn't want to stop being with him. He turned, sensing her coming, said something in his phone, then closed off the call.

"You put yourself back together, Chang."

"Thanks for waiting."

"What else am I going to do?" he said, looking around at the view, hands turned up to receive sunshine in his palms. "I fucking love it here."

"And I thought you came all this way just for me."

"You know that I did. I wanted to to fuck you in my favorite place," he said, put a hand on her waist, slipped it to the small of her back and pulled her close. "And no, I don't mean your ass."

She couldn't help laughing despite the heavy feeling she had. She moved into him, pressed her cheek against the hard muscle of his chest.

“What do you want to do now?” he said, his voice low and near her ear.

“I have to go back to Josh.”

“Let me take you guys out for dinner tonight.”

“Where would you take us?” she said, pushing back from him and looking up.

“I bet they’ve got a great steak here in Grand Cayman. Let me take you guys out for steak and whiskey.”

“That’s just for me.”

“Then whatever you want.”

“Why do you want to see me with Josh?”

“I just want to see you. You say the word and it’s just you and me out tonight. Make that happen and I’ll be even happier.”

“Do you want Josh to see me with you?” She watched as the smile pulled to one side, and his eyes narrowed.

He said, “What would he think?”

“You want to hurt him?”

“Not at all, Kimmy,” he said, practically rolling his eyes. “That’s not it at all.”

She took a deep breath, looked back at the parking lot behind Devlin, saw her BMW parked. “How did you get here?”

“That’s my car over there. The Mercedes.” Parked on the opposite side of the lot was a red Mercedes convertible.

She said, “I’ll tell you what—maybe there’s something we could do . . .”



Every chance he got where he thought neither of them was looking, he would shoot swooping sidelong glances at Kimmy, his pupils darting over her, feverishly intent on finding something that would spike his anger. His jealousy. Or even his lust.

That's what drew him most to examine his wife's clothing. Lust. Proof she had done the terrible thing he'd always been suspecting of her. The way Devlin looked in his eyes and told him he and Kimmy had gone by his hotel room together so he could pick up his things. This was worse than when he thought she might've gone to a bedroom in the Royal York Hotel. This was proof. She'd been in a room with Devlin, and that room contained a bed.

His heart raced. He had difficulty swallowing. The three of them came into the foyer, then walked into the high-ceiling sitting room, congregating in front of the closed off fireplace and mango wall.

His eyes still scanned his wife. Shirt tucked in. Skirt straight. Jacket not crumpled. Still wore her pendant necklace. Had her hair been retied? Were there any scuffs on her shoes? . . .

Devlin asked: "So what do you think of the place, Josh?"

And just the way the guy stood made him so mad. Standing tall, hands on his hips, looking up and around like he owned the place.

But this was his place now. Kimmy's place, and thus his as well. Devlin didn't own this place. His company didn't own this place. Rented it.

Or maybe they did own it . . .

Either way, it was Kimmy who had earned the right to be here. And yet, as much as the anger rippled through him, all he could manage was a tepid:

“Yeah, it’s pretty great. We really like it.”

We really like it? This guy might be fucking your wife.

No, that wasn’t true.

Stand up straight.

He put his hands in his pocket, stood straighter, moved closer to Kimmy.

“We really do like it.”

Devlin said, “I knew you guys would. See, Josh? Nothing to worry about at all. And you thought you didn’t want to come . . .”

“No, I did want to come.”

Kimmy said, “We’re very happy to be here, thank you, Devlin,” and slipped an arm over the small of Josh’s back and hugged his waist. He put his arm around her shoulders, the two of them facing Devlin together.

Devlin said, “I don’t want to keep you guys. Kimmy says you’re going out for dinner. She won’t even let me take you guys out. Too bad, I know some great spots.”

Kimmy laughed and said, “You can just tell us where they are, you know.”

“I need to have my secrets,” Devlin said, grinning at her.

Kimmy laughed and said, “You’re terrible.”

And that sudden camaraderie between them spiked his heart again.

He broke from Kimmy, determined to make Devlin’s visit brief. “I’ll make drinks. What can I get you?” He shot a finger at Devlin like he figured one of Devlin’s buddies might do, bunch of big shots.

“There’s a fifteen-year-old in the kitchen,” Devlin said, adding, “Scotch, I mean,” before laughing.

Yeah, that's what he and his buddies would joke about. Getting a fifteen-year-old. Bunch of rich, smug assholes.

He said, "They're not labeled."

Devlin said, "One with the emerald lid, Josh," reminding him that as much as Josh might be staying here, this villa was still on Devlin's bill.

But it wasn't Devlin's. Even if his company did own it, that was his father's company. Not Devlin's . . .

"One thing I'll say," Josh said, pausing at the kitchen doorway, "you really got my wife drinking whiskey."

Devlin looked at Kimmy and smiled. "She's a woman with great taste."

He hated the sick smile on that smug son of a bitch's face. Everything he presented to Devlin—from niceties to veiled threats—were batted away like Josh Waters didn't matter. Didn't exist. Calling Kimmy Kimmy Chang.

Josh smiled at his wife now. "Kimmy? What can I get you?"

She said, "I'll have whatever you're having, Josh." Then she smiled at him.

Was that a shared moment? He was pretty sure it was.

He smiled back at her warmly, hugged the archway for a second, then rapped his knuckles twice on the wall. "Coming right up, baby."

"Thanks, baby," she said after him.

What the fuck? Now he was in the kitchen all by himself, leaving those two alone together. Great planning, Josh.

What's the difference? They just came from Devlin's hotel room. What were they going to do, shag one out super-quick while you're mixing three drinks? Get a grip.

Before he pulled down glasses from the cupboard, he took a moment's pause to lay his sweaty palms flat on the cool of the kitchen counter. Took some deep breaths. Worst thing was there was definite plumpness in his underwear. Whatever blackness swirled inside him, right now it did more than just churn his stomach and squeeze on his heart. It riled him. Aroused him.

Soft footsteps came into the kitchen, and he moved quick to look like he was busy making drinks.

"Hey, baby," Kimmy said, slinking up behind him and hugging her hands over his stomach. She pressed her chin into his collar. "I'm so sorry."

"It's totally okay," he said. "I told you I'm okay with this."

She said, "We can work through it, I swear. It's you and me together. You hear me?"

Now he turned in her clutch and faced her, put his hands on her shoulders. "I do hear you. I appreciate it. . . . How did he end up here?"

"I was done my meeting with Rathburn, I come out to the lobby and he's just there waiting for me. He said he had business here after all, and he just swung by in case I was still at Rathburn's."

"That guy's so fucking weird."

"He's my boss . . ."

"I swear he's doing this to get to me."

"Maybe you're right. We're not gonna let that happen, though, right?"

"We're in this together," he said, "I remember," thumbing her shoulders.

"You and me," she said, locking eyes with him.

"So what we do? Couple drinks, go sit by the pool, then he gets the fuck out of here, right?"

“Right,” she said, nodding.

“Okay, I’m going to go make drinks. Let’s make this quick.”

“All right,” she said, “I’m going to go change,” and stepped back from him.

He grabbed her hand quick and pulled her to kiss him. When the when their mouths came apart, he looked in her eyes and said, “I love that you sent me to hell.”

She smiled till her eyes narrowed. “Did you feel the hellfire?”

“Hot as blazes,” he said, circling a hand on her back.

Kimmy giggled, hugged her head to his chest. “Thanks for getting me a T-shirt.”

“Devlin thought it was a band. Fucking moron.”

She laughed again, but said no more. Then: “I’ve got to go put my swimsuit on,” she said, “hurry up and make drinks and we’ll get him out of here.”

For Devlin, he poured whatever ostentatious whiskey was in the emerald-lidded crystal decanter into a highball glass. For himself, he mixed the old Hemingway. Cuba Libre. In Toronto—despite Hemingway’s formative newspaper presence—just called a plain old rum and Coke. He left Kimmy’s on the counter, strolled out to the sitting room where Devlin stood by the window admiring the view.

Look at the guy, standing there so confident. Wearing his shorts with his stupid tanned legs. Who cares if he has muscles? Who cares if he’s tall? He had that personality you had to deal with.

He came up beside him, presented him the whiskey. “There you go.”

“Thanks, Josh.” Before Josh lifted his glass to his mouth, Devlin presented his so they could clink together.

When their glasses touched with a high singing note, Devlin said, “To Kimmy.”

Josh groaned interiorly, grimacing at a toast made with this man over his wife, but imbibed anyway. Much better than whiskey. Manly, too. Hemingway was manly.

He said, “So, bit of an emergency meeting, coming out this way.”

“I didn’t want to get in your guys’s way. You know, come down on the plane with you and all unless I was invited.”

“And you had to meet with Rathburn?”

“No, not really. Other stuff’s got me here, but I was driving past Rathburn’s, I looked at the clock, thought, hey, might as well see if Kimmy’s still there. I offered to take you guys out for dinner, but she said”—now he paused to make finger quotes, his hand big enough to do it and still wrap his thumb around the highball glass—“this is Josh’s and my time.”

“Well,” Josh said, feeling proud, “it was nice of her to invite you by for a drink.”

“Kimmy’s a class act.”

A nice thing to say, and yet Devlin’s words of familiarity still bugged him. This fucking guy had dominated their topic of conversation last night. Had him breaking down. Had his wife breaking down. All he had to do to get through it, he reminded himself, was whenever he looked at Devlin was just picture the nice house he and his wife would buy in a few years when it was time to begin their family. Devlin was just a big juicy steak. To a hungry man. Or hungry woman.

The sound of the plumbing for the shower in the master suite bedroom had him turning to look down the hall; Kimmy was having a shower first.

He cleared his throat now. Took in a deep breath. He said to Devlin, “You want to step outside with me?” . . . Before he’d even finished the words, he

felt himself flinching. That was provocative. If he'd said that to Devlin in high school, Devlin would've fucking knocked him on his ass. You want to step outside? That's what guys said when it was time to fight. But this wasn't high school anymore. They weren't dumb teenagers. They were both men. This was about his wife. And about his honor. He didn't mean step outside for a fight. He meant to do what he'd planned to do when he returned to Toronto . . .

Toy

Out in the sun, Josh turned and closed the sliding glass door behind him.

“Hey,” he said to Devlin, “come on over here.” He sat down next to his goods collected from hell, and pointed to the chair opposite him.

Devlin adjusted it so would face him and sat down. “What’s up?”

He got straight to the point: “I have a feeling you and I talked at the party.”

“What do you mean a feeling?”

“You tell me. Did we talk at the party?” His face was stoic and grim.

Devlin leaned forward. “You’re talking about Tiffany’s party?”

“You said we didn’t talk. I know we talked.”

Devlin shrugged, said, “I guess we talked for a bit. What are you talking about?”

“Did we have whiskey together?”

“You don’t drink whiskey.”

Josh grumbled. “Sometimes I do. I’m off it right now. I had enough at Tiffany’s for a little while.”

“Wait,” Devlin said, “Yeah, now I remember.”

“We talked?”

“No, what’s-his-face brought out the bottle of bourbon. I didn’t have any . . .”

“You like whiskey.”

“I don’t drink that much.”

Josh said, “Neither do I.”

“Right,” Devlin said snidely, “I remember in the morning you looked like a train hit you.”

“So you’re saying we didn’t talk?”

“No, I said hi to you. I’m sure I did. Yeah, in the house, we talked for like two minutes.”

“And that was it?”

“I guess . . .” He took a sip of his whiskey and then pretended to study Josh curiously.

Was he lying? You could trust the guy to lie. He was a snake.

Josh said, “You can tell me. I know what you said . . .”

“What did I say?” No expression, a hint of mean.

He rolled his eyes and scoffed. “You think it’s power of suggestion?”

Calm: “What’s power of suggestion, Josh?”

“What did you say to me when I was drunk?”

“I didn’t see you when you were drunk. Not till the morning.”

“I know you did.”

“Hey, Josh, you tell me what I said, and I’ll tell you if I said it.”

He thought of blurting it out. Of just laying it on the table. Fanning out his cards so he could gloat. But how good was his hand? Not that good. He sniffed, sipped his rum and Coke.

Devlin said, “You’re mad about something.”

“Look,” Josh said. “I don’t think it’s funny. I just think we’re not in high school anymore, okay? I think that we should have grown past this—”

“Grown past what, Josh?”

“Devlin. Stop. You texted me.”

“I texted you what? When?”

“You’re the only one who could have texted me. I’m not stupid.”

Devlin sat up straighter now, took another sip of his whiskey, forearm muscles rippling in the sunlight. He looked around now, too, checked out the windows of the villa and began to smile. Got up, looming over Josh, came over to sit next to him, his weight on the padded lounge pushing Josh’s cushion up and jostling him.

“What did I text you, buddy?”

“See? You one-hundred percent know what you texted. I’m not a fucking simpleton, okay? I’m not a sucker. Not anymore. Don’t fuck around with me. That’s my wife in there. I know you need her. I know what she means to you. Means to your business. You’ve got a fucking crackerjack. That’s my crackerjack. That’s probably why you knocked the texting off. But I just want you to know, I’m onto you. Let’s just get past it. Stop with the foolish games, let’s be adults. My wife is not into games like this. If you fuck around with me—”

“What, she’d fuck me up? Your wife fight your battles?”

And for the first time since high school, he had that sizzling snap of anxious dread lace from his balls up to his brain. Fight or flight. His brain choosing flight.

His hands began to tremble as he looked up to the much taller, much bigger, much more manly Devlin Stone. And for a split second he was old high school Josh who cowered before a bully like this guy. It occurred to him to acquiesce. Say, Look, I suspect. I don't know. But can we just knock it off? Right now, if he spoke, he knew his voice would tremble. He stared dumbly at Devlin. Devlin enjoying this. Feeding off of his energy, soaking up his fright. Devlin smiled.

"Josh, I know I need Kimmy. I don't know what's got into you, but I guess . . . Look, it's gotta worry you, her working for me. Kimmy and I together all the time. In my car, in meetings, at the office. We work late sometimes . . ."

"You do?"

"She doesn't tell you?"

"No, she does. I know. Like that meeting at the Royal York."

Devlin's smile stayed, and he locked Josh's eyes. "That's right. Like that." He looked away for a moment, then returned his gaze. "Kimmy is a stone cold knockout, Josh. I'm lucky to have her. You're even luckier," he said, and he reached over and knocked Josh's glass hard enough to spill rum and coke over the side.

"Jesus," Josh said, held it out from his body so it wouldn't spill on his clothes, then set it down between his feet on the patio tile. He flicked the wet from his hand, Devlin laughing as he took another sip of his whiskey. Josh looked Devlin's way, not knowing at all what he would say, not knowing what he would do, feeling his heart squeezed tight, his stomach slithering around in his belly . . . But now Kimmy was stepping out from the sliding glass door onto the patio, and everything stopped. A swimsuit. Here was his wife, his tall, toned, and beautiful wife stepping out into the sunshine in a skimpy shimmering black bikini, every curve on her beautiful lean body exposed. The curve of her ass cheeks, her long shapely legs, the flexing tendons on her pretty feet. Turning, two thin black triangles covering her small but perfect breasts. Her nipples had humped out against the tight black fabric . . .



There was a wild thrill she couldn't deny. The hot Caribbean sun tightened the naked skin of her back; electric static floated up the hairs on the nape of her neck. Hair tied up, exposing her long neck, she showed off what she worked hard for. All bare skin for Josh and Devlin to see. Then she was turning, a big nonchalant smile on her face, holding up the rum and coke Josh had made for her while she slid closed the villa's back door. She held a folded up towel under one arm, but everything else was on display and she watched both the men's faces now. Her nipples rolled against the stretchy fabric of her small bikini top. The looks on their faces.

"Thanks for the drink, Josh," she said, pushing her feet bare feet into the pool slides she left on the patio. Right now, Josh's face was stone. Immobile. His eyes hollow, his mouth drawn. She could see his Adam's apple move. Right now, every dark sexual fear her husband had ever hosted came fluttering up from the forest floor like a kaleidoscope of butterflies. Devlin was wary. In on the game, but still unsure of what she might do . . .

She stepped nearer to them now, saying, "You guys are still dressed. I thought we were going swimming. I'm the only one—"

Devlin said, "I'll put on my trunks," his eyes having no problem at all exploring her naked flesh. She hoped Josh could see Devlin do it. Hoped it would drive him wild. Devlin had already seen every bit of her naked body, put his hands on it, put his big dick inside her . . . But as far as her sweet husband knew, this was the first time his high school bully was exposed to his star lawyer's almost naked body. This close to Josh now, she could feel his tension. He was practically vibrating.

She toyed with Devlin, saying playfully now, "Hurry up and change, we don't have all day," taking the towel out from under her arm and batting it against Devlin's hip as he walked past. Over her shoulder, she saw Devlin eyeing her naked backside unabashedly. She turned back to Josh, watched

his carved features, saw his pupils tracking Devlin. The sliding glass door opened and closed again behind her.

As if nothing strange was happening, she said to Josh, “I thought we were going swimming. We were supposed to make this quick.”

Josh’s chin turned slightly to the left then downward and his eyes fell on her in an agonal gaze.

She did her best to stop a smile, then let Josh watch the smile slowly unfold. She said, “What are you thinking?”

“I don’t know,” he said.

“Don’t you want him out of here?”

Now his eyes went over her, and he folded his arms protectively as if he was hurting. Not the response she wanted, so she put a hand on his shoulder and squeezed his upper arm. “Go get your trunks on, Josh.” She waited a beat, then: “I’m doing this for you.”

His Adam’s apple went up and down again. “Doing what?”

“I bought this swimsuit for you. For your eyes only. Went out and bought it on Friday”—she tugged at the teeny shoulder strap of the top—“now I’m using it for you in a whole different way I never anticipated.”

“What do you mean?” he said, his voice thin and croaky.

“You and I together, remember?”

“Yeah,” he said.

“Do you get me?”

He was still dumbstruck, eyes flicking to the back door, then back to her. She put her hands on his chest. “Enjoy it, Josh. I’m doing it for you.”

“Doing what?” he said again in that thin froggy sound.

“Come on, we can do this.”

“You invited him here for . . . for this?”

“No,” she said, “but now that he’s here . . .”

Slowly the cloudiness parted from his vision and an almost hopeful look passed across his face. His eyes went down her body, seeing how she was revealed. “You put . . . this on for me?”

“Tell me to change and I will.”

Now that his system was rebooting, his mainframe was coming alive again. The slightest tug of a smile showed at the corner of his lips. “You’re toying with me,” he said—not a question, but a statement.

“I would do anything, Josh. Anything to turn you on. I mean it.” She went on her toes, kissed the edge of his jaw, ran a hand over his chest and down to his stomach. “Get your trunks on. We’re going to go for a swim.”

He put his hand over hers, saying, “I can’t. I don’t want to, I don’t want to put on swim trunks.”

“Why not?”

“Devlin’s going to . . .”

“He’s going to put on swim trunks. I’m in my swimsuit. You can put on your swim trunks, Josh. Hey . . .” She cupped his cheeks with her palms, made him look at her. “You’re my husband. We’re going to go swimming.”

“But he’s . . .”

“Say it.”

“He’s looking at you.”

“But I belong to you,” she said, up on her toes again, kissing his mouth this time.

He was stiff at first, but slowly softened. She melted against him, ran her palms in circles over the points of his shoulders, broke the kiss. “Let’s play.”

“Play?”

“Josh, everything you want is right here in front of you. Take it for once. Take it. I’m offering to—”

“Play.”

“Play,” she whispered.

“What are you going to do?”

“Nothing. Nothing at all. But he’s gonna look at me, and you’re going to go wild, aren’t you?”

Her hand drifted lower, slipped her hand underneath his T-shirt from Hell, slipped two fingers into the waistband of his pants and tugged them outward, making it clear what she meant.

Slowly, Josh transformed again. Now she was his. She could see his brimming excitement and knew she held the leash on it. She switched the rum and coke to her left hand and she grabbed one of his butt cheeks and squeezed. “Get inside and get your swim trunks on . . .”



It was a drunken stumble back into the cool of the villa’s interior. He closed the sliding glass door behind him, watching out at his unbelievably beautiful wife standing practically in her underwear on the villa deck. What a gift. What a gift she was to him. And what a gift she was offering. His

heart flooded with strange bursting love for her. That she would do this for him . . .

That cold, adversarial strangeness he'd encountered with Devlin was quelled for the moment. That knot of dread in the pit of his stomach dissembling, the fear and worry pushed behind him.

A new drive got him pivoting, walking quickly through the main room and into the master suite before he could encounter Devlin. He wouldn't know what to say right now. Didn't want anything but what Kimmy was offering. Devlin's eyes on her. She'd stripped almost bare in front of her boss to tease her husband.

"Oh my God," he whispered, as he slipped into the bedroom and closed the door behind him.

He balled a fist over his heart, disbelieving this sudden unsuspecting treat. When she'd come out onto the back deck, it was like he'd been slapped in the face. Dumbstruck, for sure. His wife showing everything she had to the worst man in the world to whom she could show it. And Devlin standing there, not looking away. Looking at her. Seeing the way that bikini bottom hugged the roundness of her rump, that roundness seeming so strange on such a long and lean Taiwanese woman. God, how beautiful she was, the way she looked in that sunlight. That spike of jealous anger, fear, and lust punching through his chest when she stepped out into the sun wearing almost nothing.

Now he was stripping off his shirt, pushing down his pants. A full-blooded rock hard erection slapped up against his belly then wagged. Shit. How was he going to wear swim trunks now?

Could he jerk off real quick?

No, that would ruin it. Were the trunks baggy enough?

Now he was quick stepping to his suitcase, pulling out the trunks, slipping his legs through them. The bulge of his erection showed.

He trotted to the master suite bathroom, still humid from Kimmy's shower. Her clothing lay folded on the counter. He snatched off the biggest looking towel folded in the rack, held it outward. It was big enough.

He cowed it around his shoulders and it fell to the tops of his thighs. If he shifted the angle of the towel, he could cover his erection. Once he was in the pool, he'd be fine.

Back in the family room now, he could see through the glass door. Kimmy still stood with her rum and Coke. Only now, Devlin was with her. No more in his shorts and tight-fitting black polo, the guy wore swim trunks and nothing else. Tanned. Tall. And muscular.

He'd anticipated it, but it hit him way harder than he thought. Just like three minutes ago when Devlin got his first look at Kimmy's almost naked body, now Kimmy was seeing Devlin's.

Devlin stood a head taller than her. His shoulders were broad. Veins coursed over his biceps in thick cables then branched in to a webwork across his muscular forearms. He had abs. Hair on his chest and stomach. Muscular legs. Kimmy was seeing it all. Kimmy was taking it in. Standing next to Devlin, looking so small and lean and feminine and powerful . . .

Shit, he was being toyed with. Kimmy was toying with him right now . . .

Working

This was an incredible gamble, and now that it was truly underway she was seized by a strangling unsureness. Most prominent in her mind right now: was this ruse so transparent she would be discovered? Her heart beat drummed against her esophagus.

Josh emerged into the bright Cayman sunlight of the back deck. They were so far from home, so far from where they lived. Where they really existed.

And seeing Josh so far from her, facing her with profound angst, open and unsuspecting, made her feel so far from who she really is. Or was. How far they'd come in the last few months. How different their lives were. When was it exactly she'd become such an adept liar? And what if she only thought she was adept?

Right now Josh was witnessing her standing next to his fearsome nemesis, and she'd told Josh this was play between a husband and wife, her trying to turn her husband on. Couldn't Josh see through it? Looking at her right now, seeing her decrepitude, her callous lying, her manipulation. What if the act of standing comfortably next to Devlin, both of their bodies well-revealed, gave confirmation to Josh some fear he'd already suspected? Her attempt at preserving the fraying connection to her husband revealing far too much, exposing herself, her lies and enormity . . .

What made her even want to pursue something so dangerous? Why not leave this alone, meet with Devlin once a week in his apartment until the excitement of their tryst fizzled, and then let your life return to normal? Some strange erotic urge was driving her forward, heedless of sensible caution, plunging headlong into a murky lubricious mire.

It was a frozen moment, and she feared the longer she stood speechless next to Devlin, the more the realization would occur to her husband. They've already been together. So with a spreading smile, she said, "Hey, look who's finally ready," and wagged her fingers to Josh. And then, just like that, any worry she had the truth would slap Josh across the face, her husband shared a secret smile with her, knowing what the game was, and coming to her side he took her hand and she gripped his warm palm.

"Got your drink?"

"Right," he said, let her hand go and moved to the table to retrieve his rum and Coke.

With his back to them, she chanced a look at Devlin. Neither of them showed any expression on their faces. Devlin was the wild card here. What she wanted to do was a mammoth step. One meant to possibly set her and Josh on a path where the sins she'd already committed could be absolved somehow. The biggest problem was that she needed to rely on Devlin. And Devlin had a mind of his own. He had a role to play today and, thankfully, she believed he wanted this role. For that reason, maybe she could trust him to do this without it blowing up in their faces. That thought produced a wavering worry: What if it did blow up in their faces? What if Devlin screwed this up today? It would be like stabbing Josh in the heart. And what would Josh do? He would reel and hurt and likely howl in pain at the terror she'd caused . . .

A quick shake of her head loosened those thoughts' grip. If she traveled down that path, she'd likely be the one to wreck things, not Devlin. So as Josh returned with his drink, she took his hand again and kissed his cheek.

Devlin said, "What a cute couple. Holding hands and everything. Josh, you're one lucky motherfucker."

She laughed, because she knew—or figured, at least—that was the kind of thing that would rile Josh. But then she flipped it over: "I'm the one that's lucky."

Devlin raised his glass and said, "You guys were meant for each other."

Josh squeezed her hand and agreed. “We were made for each other.”

“You guys been dating since high school?”

“No,” she said. “We were just friends in high school—”

“Well,” Josh said, chest puffing out. “We did share a moment . . .”

“Oh, yeah,” she said, smiling and looking in his eyes. She said to Devlin, “We kissed just before the end of school year in grade eleven.”

Devlin smiled, said, “Who kissed who?”

She frowned, contemplating.

Josh said, “I don’t know. I guess it was mutual,” and looked to her.

Devlin said to Josh, “You were timid?”

The muscle in Josh’s jaw flexed. “Not timid. I couldn’t believe it was going to happen.”

Devlin made a face that said what was on his mind. That if it were him, he would have made it known, that he would’ve sealed the deal. She could see Devlin’s meanness now in the way he dealt with Josh. Could see why Josh would be so bothered by him. She gave Josh’s hand a squeeze, seeking to remind him that they were in this together.

Josh said, “I like the way it turned out.” He held his gaze with Devlin’s. There was something she liked about seeing Josh stand up to Devlin. There was something exciting that she hadn’t expected.

She said, “We didn’t start dating until university.”

“That’s good,” Devlin said, “for you both, I guess.”

Josh sniffed, sensing the inference, and his chin jutted forward. “What does that mean?”

Devlin smiled, then the smile went away as he figured how he would say this. Her heart began to beat faster, worrying that Devlin would take this too far. He said, “Josh, you got a chance to see how terrible it would be without her, and in that time, Kimmy . . .” He shrugged and smiled crooked.

Got to sow her oats.

She avoided his line of thought, but said, “Honestly, it just gave me a chance to study.”

Devlin raised an eyebrow. “You didn’t date anyone before Josh.”

“No, I did—”

“We both did,” Josh said.

And that made her stomach twitch. She hadn’t anticipated being bothered by Josh proudly stating that he’d been with girls before her. She squeezed his hand, and when he looked, she frowned at him. Josh said, “What the heck, what are we doing standing on the patio? Weren’t we going swimming?”

“Boy,” Devlin said, “you guys really want me out of here.”

She laughed first to cover anything shitty that Josh might say.

Josh said, “It’s not that,” and checked his watch but wasn’t wearing one.

Devlin looked at him.

Josh said, “Let’s just go swimming,” and gestured a hand to the path that led from the patio to the walkway.

Devlin wouldn’t follow Josh’s instruction and instead sipped his whiskey, waited, then finished it off. He set the empty glass on the table.

Josh said, “You want another?”

Devlin said, “No, I know you want to get things going.”

“No,” Josh said. “Let me get you another.”

“I’m kidding, Josh,” Devlin said, putting up his hands like Josh was being foolish. “I don’t want to have more than one. It’s the middle of the day.” They looked at each other, Josh and Devlin, and she watched Josh’s mouth move around. Josh was trying to parse the insult in there, and she could see a glimmer of it: I don’t have a drinking problem. Not like you. . . . I heard what you did at the party. Got piss drunk and passed out. And if Devlin were to look her way . . . And all Josh thinks is I pinned you in the grass and dry humped you. Why don’t we tell him the truth? . . .

“Josh,” she said, “let’s go freshen our drinks.”

Josh said, “Yeah, okay. Let me.”

“I’ll come in with you.”

“No, no worries. I’ll just be a second. You guys go to the pool.”

“No, we’ll wait for you.”

“I’ll just be a second,” he said again, “I’ll be right behind you,” and he took her glass and headed back to the sliding glass door. She and Devlin watched him go into the house.

She waited a long beat, making sure Josh wasn’t spying on her from inside the villa. Without looking at Devlin, she said, “So far, so good.”



While he was mixing them fresh Cuba Libres, he fantasized about what Kimmy would do with him next. This was unbelievable. This was some sort of cognitive-behavioral therapy. His wife had sexualized his fear of Devlin. And never in a million years would he have ever thought it could be so

fucking thrilling. His stomach muscles tensed, his heart beat hard. And he might not have too bad a plump bulge in his swim trunks if they got wet—his dick was half hard. And that was just from the idea that Kimmy would even engage in this play, not yet the play itself.

He rushed the drinks, barely measuring the rum, then moving quickly to return to the sliding glass door, excited but afraid to see what Kimmy had prepared for him.

He wasn't disappointed.

Kimmy was displaying herself for her handsome boss. Her perky butt leaned against the back of a chair, her hands over the top of the curved chair rail. She faced Devlin, her chin tilting, her pretty face turned toward him. Her deep black hair gleamed. She was displaying to Devlin how beautiful she was. How flat her stomach was. Her perfect, creamy skin. The tone of her lean muscle and the slenderness of her joints and the grace of her long neck.

The sight of his wife like that drove him wilder than he'd ever felt for her before. His temples throbbed from an erotic ache.

Now he wished Devlin weren't here, and he would go out now, and he knew that Kimmy would let him do anything to her body he wanted. She was his. Absolutely his.

But that would ruin this play. Imagine how he felt right now, multiplied by every passing minute she spent teasing him in front of Devlin. . . . The two of them in on the joke on that piece of shit together. The two of them turning his high school bully on his ear. The more he was bullied right now, the better it would be for him—because Kimmy would reward him with sex when Devlin's big, dumb, musclebound ass was out of here.

He slid open the door, slid it closed with an elbow. "Fresh drinks," he said, crossing to them like he didn't have a care in the world. He passed Kimmy her drink, then tapped his glass to hers. "Shall we go swimming, baby?"

"It's about time," Devlin said.

Kimmy joked with Devlin. “You got somewhere else to be?”

“I’m at your whim today, counselor?”

See? . . . Their interplay was riling him even further. Kimmy was doing this for his benefit.

Kimmy said, “You’re a guest in my villa.”

“You don’t think you’re on the clock today?”

“I know I’m not on the clock today,” she said, never breaking her smile.

The two of them engaging in banter like this began to worry at his stomach. Was this what they were like when they were alone together? The two of them being cute, making jokes, trying to rip on each other, looking for leverage at the other one’s expense. In close quarters. In Devlin’s luxury Mercedes. At the Royal York. . . . Was Devlin always working on Kimmy? Was Devlin always trying to get in Kimmy’s pants? . . .

Josh said, “I guess I’ll lead the way,” and walked around them, feeling bolder the more this went on. Feeling like they could actually do this crazy thing together. If Kimmy ever had some crazy kink, he would love to do for her what she was doing for him right now.

With them behind, he turned left to the path that would take them to the center of the estate’s compound where there was a forty-foot pool with a water-slide and landscaped waterfall.

Kimmy said, “Josh, let’s go down to the ocean.”

He turned to see them both standing at the trail’s intersection, Kimmy pointing downward to where they had a private spot of beach together.

“Good idea,” Devlin said. “Way more private. We don’t have to sit with people we don’t like.” His eyes moved toward Josh’s, Josh smiled at him.

Yeah. We don’t like each other.

Josh said, “Whatever you guys want.” Laissez-faire, cool, unperturbed.

Meanwhile, everything inside him was twisted and rolling in tightening knots. It was turning to see them together again that renewed the tight internal angst. Kimmy and Devlin standing together, choosing the path where they would all head. Kimmy standing in the skimpiest of bikinis. Devlin next to her, revealing all that skin. The two of them close . . .

“Makes sense,” he said.

Kimmy and Devlin went ahead, and began to descend the trail in front of him as he trailed behind. Kimmy was in the lead, walking carefully in her flip-flops down the beaten path, the bright Caribbean water up ahead. Her slim figure was provocative. Her bikini bottoms were smaller than underwear. He watched the taut jiggle of her perfect butt cheeks as she moved on her toes down the path. And Devlin was in front of him.

A quick glance at Devlin revealed his head angled directly toward Kimmy’s incredible ass.

Josh’s hand formed a fist, and he pressed it against his bellybutton. He gritted his teeth. The feelings Kimmy was provoking in him were overwhelming. She’d never looked more beautiful, more alluring or sexual. How did he end up with her? Devlin’s words could make sense. Had he taken Kimmy for granted?

No. . . . They were in this together.

Down at the waterside, Kimmy tossed her towel on one of the two loungers and set her rum and coke on the wide flat arm rest. Devlin walked around her, unabashedly ogling, then stepped into the water up to mid-calf. He looked to the left and around to the right. They were the last villa at the end of a line, and the shore at the estate extended in a crescent. It meant their spot was secluded. Even if the residents of the neighboring villa would come down to spend time at the water’s edge, they would be about fifty feet ahead, their backs to them.

Kimmy turned to wait for him, smiling. As they got closer, she whispered, “How’s it going?”

He got close and whispered, “You’re driving me crazy,” and pecked her on the lips. She chuckled and tapped her fingers against his bare side. The feel of that graceful hand on his skin was bringing him to full hardness again. Up and down, up and down—his cock was getting a real workout this afternoon.

He set down his drink on the chair next to Kimmy’s, claiming it. Too bad for Devlin there were no seats left. Oh, well . . .

He called out to Devlin: “How long you been coming here?”

Devlin idly kicked his legs through the water, his muscular arms hanging at his sides. “A few years, I guess.”

“And how long has your dad had it?”

Devlin’s smile flickered, knowing what Josh was doing. He nodded once.

“That I don’t know,” he said, “Josh, but I’ve been here a few times when I was a teenager. What’s that, fifteen years maybe—why? You in the market for a place in the Caribbean?”

“Not at all,” he said. “We’ve got this one,” and smirked Kimmy’s way. Kimmy gave him a warning glance. He recalled her words issued to him many times: Don’t forget he’s my boss.

Devlin said, “If your wife keeps making me happy like she is, you guys can come down here as much as you want.”

Making you happy. “She saved your ass.”

“That what she told you?”

Kimmy said, “I would never put it that way.”

“She just told me what happened.”

“I can’t take anything away from how well Kimmy’s doing. She makes coming to work every day a lot brighter than it used to be.”

Kimmy said, “Tired of seeing Mel?”

Josh’s brow furrowed. Who was Mel? Some inside joke?

Devlin said, “If I came to the Caribbean with Mel and he put on that little bikini you’re wearing, I would stab my eyes out.”

Now Josh smiled, showing none of this bothered him. Mel was that guy Kimmy had replaced. He chuckled, said, “Pretty bold.”

“How’s that, Josh?”

He said, “You like looking at Kimmy in that bikini?”

“You think that’s bold? Are you telling me she’s not worth looking at?”

“Nothing like that at all.”

Devlin looked to Kimmy, then back at him again. “You want to see bold, Josh?”

“Not really.”

Devlin said, “Best part about this villa is the privacy. I don’t wear trunks when I swim in the sea. So anyone who’s shy should probably look away.” He began to untie the knot on his swim trunks.

Josh laughed like Devlin was bluffing—but it took only a second and a half before he realized there was no way Devlin was bluffing. He was really going to do this. He shivered and his skin crawled. The hair rose on the nape of his neck and on the crown of his head. His heart beat a sudden doom-like drum beat. This couldn’t be happening.

But then Devlin turned his back to them, shoved his thumbs under the waistband of his trunks at his hips, and Josh’s natural inclination was to look away. But he was frozen. Wanting to see if Kimmy would look.

Wanting to shout out to her that she shouldn't. Wanting to lurch to her—but the lounge was between them—and spin her around. Kimmy was playing a game, and somehow Devlin had played right into it. But played into it far too deep. Making ninth inning plays in the first fucking inning. “Whoah,” he said, “you’re not really . . .”

Kimmy briefly looked to him, eyes wide and in a No way sort of expression. He went to mouth to her to turn around, but before he could, she was facing Devlin again.

Devlin, true to his word, and giving them much time to turn away if they were bashful, shoved down his swimsuit, baring his ass to them. And you'd be crazy not to know how good Devlin looked. Like some hot Playgirl model. This was like a Playgirl fashion shoot; a tall handsome well-built hunk, naked in the water up to his knees, showing off his wide back and his broad shoulders, his narrow waist, and a perfect, pale man's ass.

Josh held his breath. He turned to Kimmy, and Kimmy was looking at Devlin. Kimmy was smiling. And now he walked toward her, coming around the back of her lounge chair, looking to get a hold of her arm to tell her that they had to stop. This was too much. Too much, way too fast.

And in that instant, as he approached behind his beautiful wife, Devlin turned their way, his balled up swim trunks in one hand. He strode up through the water to the beach again, completely naked and exposed to Kimmy.

There Devlin was, in all his glory; muscular chest flexing, shoulders bulging, large hand holding the clumped swim trunks, his ab muscles rolling under the skin . . . But the most unavoidable, most prominent draw was the thing between his legs.

His huge flaccid cock slapped between his legs. Easily bigger than Josh's own erection. Dwarfing it. A big pale brownish wrinkly hose with a plump cock head half-hidden by a roll of extra skin. As he strode the water, a soft sticky flesh sound was heard over the waves: Devlin's big penis hitting his thighs.

Devlin wore a confident smile, gazing Kimmy's way. He tossed the swim trunks aside into the dry sand, winked to Kimmy, turned and strode into the water, ass muscles flexing. Once he was knee deep, he took three long strides then dove headlong into a short wave coming his way. He disappeared under the water.

Instant coldness flooded him. Shame, regret. Why did they think they could do this? This was too dangerous a game. All this time, all this talk . . . And tick by tick, Devlin was turning the pot hotter and hotter till it would boil. And Josh was the frog. Each little increment further Kimmy traveled in this relationship with her new boss was bringing her husband great torture. Even in this moment that was supposed to be pleasure.

With Devlin disappeared under the surface, Kimmy turned around finally, her face mildly shocked, but her eyebrows raised in practical fright. Her lips were parted. She couldn't believe what she saw.

There was your proof, Kimmy. That's the big penis we were joking about. That's what I told you. Now you saw it. Now you fucking saw it.

He shook his head at her, mad. Mad at her, mad at himself. But it was Devlin who deserved a punch in the face right now. No words came, and Kimmy didn't say anything either, studying his expression to gauge his reaction. But he wasn't going to blow up. He wasn't going to make a scene. Not with Devlin here. And not when he didn't even know who he was fucking mad at most.

He raised his palms, shook his head, bewildered, trying to express to her that this was somehow her fault. That she brought this on them.

He pivoted, began marching up the trail back to the villa.

There you have it, Kimmy. You finally saw it. I'm sure Amy told you all about it before. Sure there was no mystery there, no surprise. Well, shoot, never mind Amy's gossip, I practically told you. And fucking Kimmy knew it was big. Amy and Kimmy had probably giggled all night as teenagers, Amy telling her how great it was to have sex with Devlin. Kimmy had a chance and chickened out. Had she always been curious about what she'd missed?

She now had visual confirmation. Devlin's manhood was enormous. His masculinity was enormous. He was a fucking asshole, but I'm sure Amy told Kimmy about how well the guy could fuck . . .

Whelk

Josh worked his way up the trail, headed back to the villa, and she watched him go with a small measure of worry. This was the reaction she suspected, but hadn't been looking his way to gauge his facial expression before he left.

She waited till Josh was out of sight, then waited some more before she turned to look at Devlin, out in the water doing a slow breaststroke returning to shore. He watched her blankly. She set down her drink, stood, went to rinse the sand from her feet and rubber sandals, and Devlin stayed out in the water, standing up now and pushing back his wet hair. They said nothing, and she didn't smile. There was a fear in her that Josh would double back to spy what she would do in his absence.

Devlin had played his part. He hadn't fucked it up. Devlin got off on this.

She scanned the bushes around the trail, then looked back to Devlin in the water. "I'm going to go in and talk to him," she said, not raising her voice.

Devlin nodded, then pushed backwards to float on his back, his chest and stomach muscles shimmering wetly in the Caribbean sun. That sight of him was like an unexpected punch in her stomach. There was something about him that turned her on so much.

Now she began to stroll the trail, following Josh back to the villa, arms folded, her posture slumping in a mock timidity. Josh wasn't at the pool, wasn't on the villa patio, and she went through the sliding glass door, closing it behind her, her skin prickling from the cold of the air conditioning. "Josh?"

There was no sound for a moment, and she wondered just how far away he'd run. But then from the kitchen: "In here."

She found him standing in the kitchenette, arms folded like her, butt against the counter edge and staring at the floor. His expression was surly. When she approached him, he looked up. "Sorry," he said. "Go back swimming. I just need a minute."

"Tell me what you're thinking."

"What I'm . . . What do you think I'm thinking?"

"I don't know, Josh," she said, "that's why I asked you to tell me."

He shrugged and looked away. "I don't know what I'm thinking. I'd tell you if I did."

"Are you mad at me?"

He shook his head, scoffed and made an exasperated sound. "So, you like playing games, Kimmy, and there: we just got played."

"We got played?"

He looked up. "You don't think so?"

Don't be so weak, Josh. She said, "If you think you just got played, why are you in here?"

"Because of what happened."

"Him playing you?"

"Kimmy, the guy's your fucking boss, and he just took his pants off and showed you his dick. What the fuck am I supposed to think? What the fuck am I supposed to do about it?"

"Don't be mad."

His voice was still raised. “I’m not mad, Kimmy. I’m just . . . How come you can’t see this my way?”

“Josh, don’t be cross with me. Don’t raise your voice to me. I’m trying to see it your way. . . . Whatever happened to us being in this together?”

“Devlin took his swim trunks off and you looked. That’s what happened.”

“So you are mad at me?”

“Just forget it.”

“Don’t be like that, Josh. I’m not kidding.” Her serious tone got him looking her way. “You can bring this torment on yourself. It’s in your control. When I said we were in this together, that’s what I meant. He has no control over you, Josh. None.”

“I think he does.”

“Hey,” she said, and got closer. Josh wasn’t going to blow up. He didn’t even know who he was mad at. She touched his forearm, then stroked down to circle her fingers around his wrist. “Hey, I’m serious. He doesn’t control you anymore.”

“Why did you look?” His eyes raised to hers, clear and quivering.

“I figured you wanted me to.”

She moved her hand away, but he took it and held it, wouldn’t let her go.

“I thought this would be fun,” she said. “I was doing this for you.”

His expression showed shame. “How can this be for me?”

And though she didn’t the question was directed at her, she answered. “I don’t care, Josh. Want my psychoanalysis? I’m probably wrong. . . . All I know is that you’ve been a bundle of nerves since I started working for him, and the only thing that’s made you anything close to the Josh I love is when

you're opening up to me. All I ever wanted was to make that Josh happy. To get closer to that Josh."

His lips puckered as he chewed the corner of the inside of his mouth, nodding. "I'm not mad at you," he said at last. "I don't know who I'm mad at."

"You don't have to be mad at anybody."

"Kimmy, you have to go back to work on Monday with him. And he just showed you his dick." He held her eyes steadfastly.

She said, "So what? It's nothing I didn't know about already."

He hung his head, defeated, deflated. "But you saw it. You . . . did you mean you've seen it before?"

"No," she said, deflecting.

"Amy?"

She frowned. "Amy what?"

"What did she tell you?"

"Tell me? About . . . that? Everybody knows. Yeah, Amy talked about Devlin in that way. But so do you."

He shook his head. "Well, now you saw it."

"Now I saw it." She waited to see what he would say.

Josh raised his chin to look at her again. "I don't know how to feel about that."

She slumped, leaned her almost naked body against his. Her nipples had hardened from the air conditioning's chill, and she let the bulb of one nipple press against his arm. It felt good to stroke it against him, and she knew it

would drive him wild. “So what he has a big dick. So what if he showed it to me.”

He looked at her sidelong. “Because you have to go to work on Monday.”

“Josh, I already know he has a big dick. I know practically as much about it as you do.”

“I don’t like the idea of you working with him.”

“Josh, why do you always have to take it there? We were doing so well together.”

“We’re doing fine,” he said, gripping her forearm and spinning her so they faced.

Their eyes met and lingered. She said, “You’re in control of this, Josh. More than you even know. Stop being your own worst enemy.”

“Think that’s what I do?”

“You know it. You said it to me. I think you might be right.”

“What’s a man supposed to do in a situation like this? I don’t even know. Go down, tell him to get out? That’s what I should do. That’s what I feel like I should do. But, I feel like I should go down there and knock him out.”

“How would you do that?”

“You don’t think I could?”

“If that’s what you think you should do . . .”

“You don’t think that’s what I should do?”

“Not when I went to great trouble to get this to happen. Get it to happen for you. I didn’t do this so you could punch him.”

He groaned and his head rocked back while his eyes closed.

She said, “Did you forget that part? How do you think I feel wearing this in front of Devlin?” She plucked at the strap of her bikini top. “You think I like walking around in front of my boss like this? I know I have to go see him on Monday. Now he knows what I look like half naked. I did that for you, and you’re letting it . . . You’re wasting it.”

“Wasting it?”

She kissed his cheek. “You’re sexy, Josh. You’re sexy and I love you. Keep fighting these weird feelings you have. Keep fighting the past. Meanwhile, we’re here in the present. You and me. I’m making a fool of myself out there and I’m doing it for you. You’re in the villa sulking like this is still high school.”

He sighed heavily. “Kimmy, just tell me what to do.”

“I want a man who knows what to do.”

“Is that an insult?”

“You’re that man, Josh. Show me how strong you are.”

“I am strong.”

“I like it when you stand up to Devlin,” she said, slinking against him.

“You like that?”

“I already told you.” She scratched the point of his chin with her index finger. “Just remember he’s my boss. Don’t take this too far. I’m your wife. You’re my husband. You’re up here saying we got played. Devlin doesn’t even know this is a game. Our game.”

“What do you want me to do?”

“Show him you’re not afraid, Josh. The Josh I love isn’t a coward.”

“You want me to go and punch him?”

“How do you think that will go, Josh?”

“You don’t think I could take him?”

She tried not to humiliate him, keeping her features relaxed. “Do you? And then I’m out of a job too, by the way.”

“We’ll sue him for wrongful dismissal. He took his pants off in front of you.”

“As much as you’d like to, do you really think that’s fair?”

“Why?”

“If we go to court, we have to lie?”

“Lie how?”

“Josh, you and I are playing a game right now. A weird game for our sex lives. I don’t know what’s even letting me do this. This is crazy. But I’m doing it for you. I’m going to lie and say that Devlin didn’t warn us to look away? Why wouldn’t I look away? You want somebody to ask me that?”

His brow lowered as he contemplated. “No.”

“Josh, you’re smart. You’re not a coward.” She ran her fingers through the hair above his ear. “Figure it out. So what Devlin has a big dick? That doesn’t mean anything except to you.”

“That’s why he showed it to you.”

“For your sake. I know that’s true.”

“No, he wanted you to see it. I know he did.”

She let her hand fall from where it cupped his neck, slipped it under the towel still wrapping his shoulders. She rested her hand on his chest, ran it down the warm length of his trim body. Plucked out the front of his swim trunks’ waistband. Josh held his breath. She looked over her shoulder to

make sure Devlin wasn't coming, then tugged the front of his shorts down to expose his throbbing, upright erection. She circled her hand on it and gently stroked. "I'm going to say this is proof what I did for you was pretty amazing."

"It was," he croaked.

She smiled. "You have an amazing wife. Say it."

"I have an amazing wife," he repeated, eyes narrowing.

"And I have an amazing husband. A husband who is my best friend. Who I love spending time with. Who I wouldn't have come to Cayman without. My boss has a big, giant . . . cock . . ." She squeezed tight her grip on Josh's erection and his knees buckled. He bit his lower lip. "But in my hand is my cock. The best cock in the world. My favorite one." She ran her thumb around this pee hole.

He grumbled, "What did you think?"

"What was that?"

"What did you think of . . ."

"We've got a guest, Josh. I don't have time right now. You're free to come down to the water," she said, letting his cock go but keeping his trunks tugged down so his erection still stuck out. "I'd like it if you came down and joined us. Come down and show me you're not afraid. Come down and show me you're in control. I don't want you to punch him in the mouth. That's crazy. You and I are having fun together. Devlin's just a tool." She got close to Josh's ear and whispered, "A really huge tool," and nibbled on his earlobe.

"Lucky me," Josh sighed, a sheepish smile breaking his face now. She'd beaten him. Won him over through the art of persuasion.

She grabbed the two ends of the towel around his shoulders and gripped it tight, pulling him close like she was holding him by his lapels. "Come

down to the water. Come down and show Devlin I'm your wife. Don't hide up here. Show me and show Devlin who my husband is." She kissed him on the mouth, smiled and flossed the towel back and forth across the back of his neck. She patted him on the chest, pivoted and strolled from the kitchenette, running a finger under the bikini bottom where it curved her ass, snapped it in place, knowing Josh was watching . . .

Bravado

For more than a full minute he stood in the kitchen listening to the pounding of his own heartbeat, wide eyes staring at the last place he'd seen his wife—walking from the kitchen to the sliding glass door. That perfect ass, that beautiful bare body on display . . . As the shock wore off, he was flooded with a strange sense of power. A gift from Kimmy.

He chuckled and groaned into his palms then held the back of his neck, trying to comprehend what the hell was happening here, and how it came to be. How did it come to be? You have an amazing wife who gets you completely—anxious parts of you hidden so deep inside that you couldn't even see them, though you knew they were there somewhere lurking in the shadows. "Ha, ha," he chuckled, "oh, my God, fucking Kimmy Chang . . ."

Somehow, despite the awfulness of the day, there was a smile on his face. Five minutes ago, his high school bully—his wife's boss—had taken his trunks off to swim naked in the sea. He'd displayed his impressive penis and Kimmy had looked at it. She looked at her boss's penis for her husband's sake.

He tugged up the front of his swimsuit to cover his erection, but palmed it over the satiny front. "Oh, my God," he sighed again, stroking himself. The gift was too huge to comprehend; it had left him bewildered.

But then, everything was thrust into gear, and he was jumping off the counter where he leaned. Kimmy was down at the beach. Kimmy was down there without him. Devlin was down there completely naked. Swimming. Without Josh nearby, Devlin would definitely come out of the water and swing that big thing around, flaunting it like he used to flaunt it in the

shower room. Only, instead of intimidating his locker room brethren, he would be enticing another man's wife. Letting her know what her husband did not have.

His stomach tightened hard enough to make him double over and squat down on the kitchen floor. But instead of fear, he felt lust. There was a party down at the water and he was up here missing it.

"Kimmy, Kimmy, Kimmy," he groaned as he stood, still bewildered, mind racing.

Then in a flash he was moving. Going to the fridge—changing his mind and darting to the liquor cabinet.

He didn't come up to the villa to escape. He didn't come up here to hide or cower away from fearsome Devlin, masculine, well-hung Devlin. No, he wasn't that coward anymore. This wasn't high school.

He swiped up the crystal decanter of single malt, went to the cupboard and brought down a clean glass. Towel still around his shoulders, covering the bulge in his swim trunks, he was out the back door, sliding it closed, and walking quick on the balls of his feet to the trail down to the shore.

What would he find? Devlin strutting around the beach with that donkey dick flopping around? Kimmy sitting in her lounge and looking at it unabashedly? Maybe even Kimmy handling it? Saying: Bring it here, let me get a good look . . .

His heartbeat pounded in his cock, and he grunted at the psychic pain that ridiculous image brought. But it got him moving quicker. And when he arrived down at the water, in contrast to his fantasies, the scene he discovered wasn't quite so exciting. But tell that to his racing heartbeat and thundering erection.

Devlin was still in the water, waves lapping around his hips. Naked under there. Showing off the shining gleam on his bulging muscles and his tight, muscled midsection. Talking to Kimmy, Kimmy standing at shore with her

rum and Coke in her hand. She turned to regard him over her shoulder, her face hidden from Devlin so she could show Josh a devilish smile.

“There he is,” she said.

And Josh got in character. “Hey, Devlin,” he said, hoisting up the decanter to show his wife’s boss. “Stay for another drink.” He set down the whisky and the glass on the arm of a lounge.

“You trying to get me drunk, Josh?” Devlin called out from the water

“You think I’m trying to get my way with you?” he said, standing confidently with his hands on his hips. He didn’t possess what Devlin had. He didn’t have that fantastic body, that impressive build, or anything like what that dong he had between his legs. There was one thing he did possess that Devlin didn’t own. This amazing woman standing on shore with him.

Kimmy said to him: “That was nice, Josh.”

Josh said, “It’s here if you like it,” then turned his back to Devlin like he didn’t matter.

Kimmy said, “Do you want to get in the water now?”

“I do feel like a swim,” he said.

She moved the cocktail to her mouth, almost sipped, then moved it down so he could see her lips. She whispered, “Are you going to wear your trunks?”

Bah-da-dump.

Kimmy didn’t say it to him in the kitchen. But that was it there. Stand up to him. Don’t let him win. I’m yours . . .

“Am I?”

She scowled like she didn’t like his timidity. “Are you?”

She rolled her eyes, turned away and set her drink on the lounge.

He said, “Not when it’s so private.”

Kimmy turned and gave him a sly face. His vision went white and hazy. What was he going to do, take his pants off right here? Was that what she wanted?

“What do you want to do, Josh?”

I want to stick it to Devlin the way you want me to stick it to Devlin. He doesn’t own me. He doesn’t control me. I’ve seen his dick a hundred times, and he’s seen mine. Does it matter?

What if he makes fun of it in front of Kimmy? What if he calls you Double-A?

Would that be so bad?

It would be life ending.

But would it?

He didn’t know. And now he was frozen, standing with a blank expression on the shore when he was supposed to be going swimming.

Would it be so terrible?

A smile began on his face as he could see the power of what Kimmy was gifting him. Could see his wife leading a path out of his dark, tortured forest. Did it matter? Maybe it didn’t. Kimmy knew his cock. And she’d always heard about Devlin’s. She’d seen it today. She didn’t drop to her knees and worship it. Imagine the look on Devlin’s face if Kimmy didn’t give that big trophy dick he sported the attention Devlin thought it deserved?

Before he could even consider the craziness of what he was doing, he was untying the knot on his swim trunks. Kimmy smiled and watched his hands work. And he smiled, too, looking at her. She looked proud. Proud that her husband wasn’t suffering under his own self-proclaimed weakness. He wasn’t weak. “It’s so private here,” he said to Kimmy.

“It sure is,” she said, eyes lowered to watch as he pushed down his swim trunks. He turned his side to Devlin, let Kimmy see as he disrobed. She checked out what he had, and he loved the look on her face.

He tossed the swim trunks and towel on to his lounge and backed toward the water, pretending he was talking to Kimmy. But they weren’t saying anything. Kimmy watched him admiringly, and his heart swelled.

“You coming in?” he said, standing up straight and unafraid.

“I’m coming in,” she said.

And then he turned, walked into the water at knee height, waiting to quickly get under the surface, but unconcerned that his rock hard erection thrust out from his body. It wagged stiffly and upright, pointing to the bright blue Caribbean sky. The water rushed cold around him, in between his legs, and then he dove forward into an oncoming wave, came up a dozen feet behind Devlin. But new fear struck him as he pushed his hair back from his face, pinched his nose and shook his head. Kimmy was on shore, coming to the water’s edge, Devlin closer to her than he was, facing her way and watching. Waiting for her to take that tiny bikini off.

But she didn’t. Instead she began to stroll into the water, elbows pointed up high as she wrangled her long hair and knotted it in a loose bun on top of her head.

Devlin said, “You’re still wearing that bikini?”

Kimmy raised her eyebrows haughtily, said, “Sorry, Devlin, I’m not going to disrobe in front of my boss.”

Devlin patted his palms lightly against the swell of seawater rushing up around his middle, saying, “It’s not really disrobing, it’s just fitting in with everyone else.”

“I don’t fit in with the guys,” Kimmy said as she got closer to him. It looked like the two were going to come face-to-face with each other, and then she said, “I might come out here later with my husband,” walked past Devlin,

smiling right at Josh now. He held his arms out, and she dove into a wave, keeping her head upright and trying to keep her hair dry. She swam right to him, and he put his arms around her.

Devlin came their way, getting under the water as well.

“This is refreshing,” he said to Kimmy.

“It is,” she said, the water cold enough to get her teeth chattering.

He said, “Good idea to come for a swim. At first I thought—”

Kimmy’s hand gripped his cock and gently squeezed.

Devlin said, “Thought what?”

“That you . . . didn’t want . . . to get wet,” he said, looking in Kimmy’s eyes while her grip stroked on his cock.

She said, “I like getting wet. Just not my hair . . .”

Devlin said, “I always knew that about you.”

Kimmy flinched. And Josh could see why. The double entendre. The purposeful sexual forwardness from her boss.

They were toying with each other, and Devlin was a device they were using. But the device was trying too hard to interact.

Josh leaned back into an oncoming wave, let it crash around his shoulders, taking Kimmy’s hands and leading her to swim with him away from Devlin. Kimmy turned her head, and he caught her looking under the water’s surface to between Devlin’s legs. For what was between them . . .

He squeezed her hands, and began to flutter kick underneath her body, the two of them getting some distance between them and Devlin. She hooked her arms around his neck and clung to him and he whispered in her ear, “Were you trying to take a peek just now?”

“Maybe,” she said, pausing a moment to bite on her lower lip, then dropping an arm under the water and gripping his cock again. “But I’ve got everything I want right here.”

“You’re driving me crazier than you ever have,” he said, eyeing past the bundled hair on top of her head to Devlin who paddled about fifteen feet off, watching, an obvious look of disgruntlement on his face. Good. Intrude on our day, will you? We’re a married couple who knows how to adapt, you musclebound dummy. We’re playing you right now.

With Devlin’s eyes on them, he pushed his mouth forward, and Kimmy closed her lips against his. They kissed. Kimmy gave him her tongue, and he took it. But now his stomach was undulating with threatening pressure. His balls felt swollen. A case of underwater blue balls right now, right here on vacation. One minute all the fun is crashed as Devlin shows up, but Kimmy flips the chess table on him. We’re not playing chess, you dick, we’re playing a totally different game. Four dimensional.

With Kimmy’s tongue in his mouth, his palm slipped along her tight, lean body, his fingers going underneath the teeny front triangle of her black bikini. Her tongue slipped away from his and she bit his lower lip hard. “Wow,” he blurted, head moving back, bottom lip still stuck in his wife’s mouth. His fingers slipped through her pubic hair and into her luscious, swollen folds. They teemed with slippery juices, and he plunged two fingers inside her with ease.

“Holy shit, you’re so fucking wet,” he whispered right in her ear.

In his ear, she whispered, “I think you might have to take me inside.”

“Right now?”

“Right fucking now, Josh,” she said, and this time she clamped her teeth on his earlobe.

“Holy fuck,” he said in her ear, and she punctuated it with another good grip on his cock.

“Like you don’t want to,” she said.

“I’m dying to,” he said, looking in her eyes.

Kimmy pushed off from him, paddling backwards, her arms spread out on either side, the muscles moving in blades in her lean shoulders. Now he imagined her naked. What if she got naked? Got naked right in front of Devlin Stone. And naked Kimmy didn’t flock to the high school football player. Didn’t fall on her knees before the school’s richest asshole boy. No, instead naked Kimmy took her husband’s hand and had to go upstairs for a midday fuck because she needed him so badly.

But it was Devlin turning her on.

No, it wasn’t.

It was.

So fucking what?

“Okay,” he said, breast stroking to follow in her wake, magnetized by the horny look in her eyes.

She turned to Devlin and said, “Can you give us a few minutes?”

“If that’s what you need,” he said.

“Josh and I have to talk about something,” she said.

Devlin nodded, but was obviously injured. He’d thought he was in control, but he wasn’t. Josh was in control. Or at least Kimmy was. No, it was the two of them together. Fuck you, Devlin.

Kimmy’s feet touched the bottom first, and she stood in the water, strode up to the beach, perfect ass on display, her tiny bikini bottom wedged up her butt crack, perfect globes of her narrow ass jiggling with her steps. Hips swaying in a way he’d never seen Kimmy’s hips sway before. Luring him. Luring her husband and taunting her boss.

Josh rose, too, coming out of the water with his naked back to Devlin, his much less impressive cock still as hard as an ingot, a rod pointed to the sky, so hard it could barely wag between his legs. Kimmy waited for him, standing at the lounge and taking a sip of her Cuba Libre. When he came to her side, she held out her hand for him. He plucked up his towel and swim trunks, tucked them under an opposite arm, and with Kimmy's hand in his, they went up the trail together.

Talking

With the towel wrapped around his waist, they crossed the public trail, then trotted together, holding hands as they entered the privacy of their villa patio. He was running on the balls of his feet, anxious to get inside before he burst out laughing. Kimmy got to the door first, swiped it open fast and jumped in. When he joined her, she slammed it shut. “Oh, my God, Kimmy, holy shit,” he exclaimed, practically doubling over. “That was so fucking crazy, God, Kimmy . . .”

She said, “I feel electrified,” and he looked to see her eyes widened, her lips parted. There was a sparkling gleam in her black eyes.

The sight of her face gripped him. He grabbed her by the shoulders, laughed, bit her neck. She tilted her chin up, put her arms around him. He hugged her so tight she could barely squirm in his grip. “You are so incredible, Kimmy, you are unbelievable.”

“This is so wild,” she panted near his ear.

He pushed her back so he could look in her eyes. “You’re the most incredible person, Kimmy. We gamed him. You and me. We gamed him.”

She said, “What game?”

“You’re so bad,” he said and laughed—the laughter chuckling from him so easily. His stomach cramped, and he doubled over again. He squeezed his fingers on her slender arms. “You are the best,” he said.

“Josh?”

His eyes darted up to meet hers. “What?”

She beat her body against his, forcing him back on his heels, her elbows against his ribs, her hands grabbing at his neck. Her mouth grabbed his. Her lips were feverish. She sucked his tongue, looked in his eyes, saying, “This isn’t about him. I need you . . .”

“I know . . .”

“I need you so bad right now,” she said, then chuckled at the desperation in her voice.

He said, “I didn’t forget,” letting his hands drop to feel the narrowness of her waist.

She said, “I need you so fucking bad, Josh,” making him walk backward, both of them headed to the bedroom.

“You really are horny,” he said.

“So fucking horny,” she laughed. “So fucking horny . . .”

“I felt how hot you were. How wet.”

“Stop talking,” she said, and kissed him again. “Come on, the bed . . .”

She took him by the hand and they darted the hall, running into the bedroom. He turned and slammed the door. Locked it. When he turned back, Kimmy was at the beach side window of the bedroom, flipping open the lever, and winding the window open. She said, “Make sure you fuck me so Devlin can hear.”

“Oh God,” he said, pushing a balled fist into his stomach again, walking toward her. She laughed, both of them driven wild by their bad behavior. While he walked, he loosened the towel where it wrapped around his hips, and let it fall free. Walked with his erection pointed up and stiffly bobbing. Kimmy watched it all the way. He pressed it against her stomach as he kissed her again. “You want Devlin to hear?”

“You think you can fuck me like that?”

He led her by the hand, falling first onto the bed and pulling her with him. His hands roamed her mostly naked body. He said, “You think he got hard looking at you?”

“Do you?” she said, stiffening, holding his gaze.

“I bet he did. I bet that’s why he wasn’t out of the water.”

She eyed him slyly. “You don’t think he’d want me to see that?”

“Would you look?”

“If you let me,” she said, biting his lower lip.

“You’re wild,” he said, “Kimmy, so wild. And I never knew . . .”

“You’re wild, too,” she said, scratching her nails on his neck underneath his ears. They kissed, and he rolled on top of her. She said, “I need it so bad.”

“You made yourself horny, acting like a bad girl.”

Kimmy chuckled. “I was so bad down there.”

“You practically showed him your bare ass, Kimmy.”

“He was looking?”

“I watched him looking. The whole time we were walking down to the beach.” He tugged away one of the bikini bra’s cups and sucked her perfect hard brown nipple. “Watched him on the trail—he couldn’t keep his eyes off your ass when you were walking down that hill.”

“You were looking?”

“I didn’t know where to look. I wanted to see your ass, but I wanted to see Devlin looking too.”

“We’re both so crazy,” she said as she raised her knees, opening herself up to him. He could feel the slick groove of her pussy sliding against his balls, then along the underside of his shaft. He groaned, ground the base of his cock to mash against her swollen labia. She said, “Be careful.”

“You’re so wet,” he said.

“And you’re so big.”

“Go on,” he said, “it is not.”

Kimmy whispered, “So much . . .”

“So much what?”

She bit her lip, flashed him a devilish smile. “So much bigger than my husband,” she whispered right against his ear.

The soughing softness of her breath tickled the fine hairs of his ear and got him shivering. The craziness of the words she’d whispered to him set off a chain of lightning that zapped through his system and set off sparks behind his eyes. “What?” His voice was a quivering whisper.

“So much bigger than Josh,” she whispered—but now she darted her head back, dark eyes uncertain as they darted across his.

“Say it again,” he said. “Fucking say it again.”

“Put it in slow, I’ve never seen such a huge cock.”

“Oh fuck, Kimmy,” he groaned, his trembling hand shoving between their bodies, fingers tugging aside the crotch of her bikini, thumbing the point of his erection into her hot, wet crease. The slick sound of hard tumescent flesh pushing past her overflowing entry made clicking suction sounds. Kimmy let out a soft, tremulous exhale.

“Slowly,” she whispered, “slowly . . . You’re so big.”

His hands grabbed fistfuls of bedding on either side of her shoulders. He clenched his eyes shut so they burned phosphorescence. His stomach tightened like a steel drum and his aching, fully hard iron erection slid into her velvet sheath. All the way in. He ground his pubic bone against hers. She moaned feminine sounds.

“It hurts,” she said, “oh God, it’s big . . .”

“Fuck, Kimmy,” he groaned, pushing into her. Pulling back and pushing in again.

“Slower, slower, mm, it’s too big, I can’t take it . . .”

“Oh Kimmy,” he moaned, pushing his fists underneath her narrow back, feeling her shoulder blades rippling against his forearms.

She wrapped her arms around his neck saying, “Go easy on my little pussy.”

“Call me Devlin,” he whispered.

“You’re so big . . . Devlin,” she said, “You feel so good though, it feels so good . . .”

His hips began to moil against hers. Hipbones crashing against hipbones. His meager size fully embedded in his wife. Both of them wriggling, their hips gyrating in circles. Not thrusting, just giving her everything he had as deep as it would go. She began to gasp. Clutched her arms around him tighter. Every full circle his hips rolled against hers, she let out a squeaking cough.

“Louder, Kimmy,” he cried out, “fucking louder—make sure Josh can hear . . .”

“Oh Devlin,” she cried, clamped her teeth on his earlobe.

His cock flexed inside her. She hissed. “God, it’s so big,” she said, tightening her hug around his back.

“Oh God, Kimmy, God, scream it for me.”

Now the circling hips became thrusts. He stabbed himself into her, getting the mattress to squeak. The headboard rattled against the wall. He pounded into her, and soon he was fucking her like a rabbit. His hips slapped into her, and he pushed back on his hands, watching his amazing wife writhe underneath him. Her eyes were closed and her head thrashed on the bed.

“You fucking like that?” he said, growling like Devlin might.

“It hurts so good, oh, it’s so big . . .”

He watched the tendons of her neck work, watched the perfect curled shape of her lips as she gasped and huffed for air.

“So much bigger than Josh,” she said, and folded an arm across her eyes, exposing only her mouth to him. “So much bigger than Josh . . .”

He watched as those familiar saintly lips formed awful words he was desperate to hear.

“I want you to come . . . come inside me . . .”

She hadn’t said Devlin, but he imagined she did. Imagined his sinful wife laying in bed, legs open, arm across her eyes so she couldn’t see the man she hated she wanted to fuck. Imagined her taking that massive cock. Imagined her asking Devlin to come inside her . . .

“You want it? You want my come?”

“Come inside me,” she said.

“Say it, say it . . .”

She moaned in her throat. “Come inside me,” she said again.

He said, “Devlin.”

Kimmy uncovered her face, but wouldn't open her eyes. Her arms thrust down, her hands grabbing the backs of her legs to hoist open wider. He fucked her faster and watched her face.

"Come inside me, Devlin, come inside me," she said, and there was no stopping what would happen next.

He growled and roared, watched her as she sensed his orgasm and cried out with him. Her nails dug into the small of his back as she grabbed his ass, pumping her hips against his, wanting him deep inside.

"So deep," she cried, face twisting toward the open window.

"Tell him, he's out there . . ."

"Oh God," she wheezed, raising her voice. Eyes still shut, veins wriggling in that swan-like neck. "Oh God," she cried out. "I'm coming, Josh, oh, I'm coming." The last word she wailed.

And she wasn't kidding. She dug her shoulders into the bed and arched her back. He supported her, digging his thumbs into the soft flesh-space below her prominent hipbones. Her butt was up off the bed; he raised up on his knees, pulled her against him so she could feel every inch he had.

"Oh God," she moaned, her face furrowed in frustration.

She coughed and cried, and spit shone on her lower lip. She clenched her teeth, then jammed her hand down where they were connected. Her two middle fingers pushed into her pubic patch, hard glossy nails rolling in circles against her clitoris.

"Come on it," Josh growled. "Come on this cock . . ."

"Oh, I'm coming," she shouted, then chomped down on her lower lip. She snorted through her nostrils, and her body stiffened. Her back arched further, her taut belly button yawning into a narrow strip. Her ribs pressed out against her skin as she began to tremble and shake, and her rolling fingers brought slick sounds.

He flexed his ass muscles, hardness dug deep inside her. And Kimmy, with her eyes closed, came on his cock. Thinking it was Devlin's cock. Imagining. Her eyes were closed off, her mind focused on the bad they'd performed together.

Kimmy was definitely thinking of what Devlin showed her today. Wondering what it would be like.

He bucked against her and she squawked. Hissed. Bared her teeth, then her mouth cranked open in a silent yawn.

"You coming on that cock?"

"Oh shit, ah," she wailed, "I'm coming, I'm still coming . . ."

Now he was too, completely boiling over like a popped champagne bottle.

He pulled his dick out and it snapped upright, shooting semen across her pubic hair and in fast moving pearly lines that rolled from her navel to her bikini top.

"Oh fuck," he said, stroking himself as Kimmy still batted at her clitoris. She was unaware he'd ejaculated on her.

He collapsed over top of her, fell against her and tried to kiss her.

"Off," she gasped, "oh, mm, I'm going to . . ."

He flopped to his side, lay next to her, watching as she continued to pleasure herself. Watched her heels dig into the bedding. Watched her toes flex upward. Watched her fast-moving hand jitter between her legs. The sound of her wetness was loud and lubricious. She coughed, trembled, and her stomach bounced. She collapsed on the bed. She'd come again. Her hand didn't stop moving. She grabbed her own breasts, eyes squinted shut, and tweaked at the nipple he'd sucked. Rolling the pad of her thumb over the saliva-slick bud. Her hips rose up off the bed again.

He pulled back the other bra cup, put his mouth on the other nipple.

“Oh, mm, ah,” she moaned in a cramped voice. Then she began chanting and crying, her breaths coming quicker and quicker.

This time when she came, she cried out loud enough Devlin would’ve heard her. All the way down at the beach, Devlin would’ve heard her. Everyone else staying at the estate would’ve heard her. Yes, they would think, seeing Josh later in the day with his cool Welcome To Hell T-shirt, that guy can fuck. That’s what they would think. Look at that shirt, maybe he’s in a band. He certainly had that hot Asian woman in ecstasy.

He grabbed the inside of her thigh. Grabbed it and growled, “Say my name.”

“Oh fuck, oh shit,” she said, coaxing another orgasm, one hand laying flat on her concave stomach, her right hand still driving two-fingered pleasure between her legs. Her graceful fingers gleamed with her wet. It sparkled in the pelt of her pubic hair that was matted and flattened by her own juices and his come. “Say my name,” he growled again.

“Oh fuck,” she cried. Then: “Oh, Devlin . . .”

“My name,” he said, and moved his hand to cup the opposite side of her beautiful face. He pinched the earring in her lobe. “My name, Kimmy.”

For a second she flashed a smile, eyes still closed off, mouth open. She arched her back, cried out his name loud enough to travel out the window. “Josh, I’m going to come again, oh Josh . . .”

Playing

Josh threw himself down heavily next to her like he was exhausted, making the bed bounce. While pleasure still throbbed between her thighs and feather-tickled her brain somewhere behind her hairline, she rolled quickly toward him, wanting him to be all right.

Josh lay on his back like she had, with his forearm draped over his eyes. His chest heaved; his cock throbbed red, standing out with veins. She ran her nails over his stomach, then hugged herself to his side. She hid her chin in his armpit, looking up to his hidden eyes.

She said, “Did you come?” then kissed his armpit, his hair’s tickling her nose.

His forearm moved, and she could see his down-turned eyes looking at her. “Oh, hell yeah, I did.”

She snuffled laughter into his armpit and hid her face from him, acting shy. He brought an arm down to put it over her shoulders and she cuddled against him.

She tapped her fingers on his chest, getting his attention. When he looked her way, she said, “That was pretty wild.”

He nodded, his eyes on hers.

“You okay?”

“Better than okay,” he said, a soulful look in his gaze.

“This is so crazy,” she said, turning to look behind her out the window at the sunny sky. She looked back to Josh. “That turned you on, right?”

He turned on his side to face her, arm around her waist and pulling her close. It felt wonderful to be held in his arms. He said, “Are you okay?”

“Me?” she said. “Don’t worry about me.”

“That didn’t freak you out?”

“Why?” she said, feigning complete incomprehension.

“Doing that for me.”

“Josh, I told you I wanted to do that for you. It worked,” she said, then tickled her nails down his stomach and grabbed his cock. He made an ooph sound and his knees jumped, batting against her thighs. “Somebody’s sensitive.”

Josh was an animal. He laughed and growled, rolled on top of her. His sweaty hair hung down to touch her forehead. He looked deep in her eyes. “I don’t want to scare you. I don’t want to—”

She pushed the pad of her index finger against his lips and mushed them. He snickered, then nibbled her finger. She said, “You know what’s going to be weird?”

He sucked her finger, let it go. “What’s that?”

“You always asking me if it’s okay.” She showed him a serious face.

“All right,” he said, nodding. “I understand.”

He kissed her warm and sticky chest, sucked her nipple again. She hugged his head and scratched his scalp. “We have to stop,” she said.

Josh let her nipple go with a wet smack, making her breast jiggle. He looked deep in her eyes again, and she knew he had an important question. She waited.

He said, "This turns you on?"

"Definitely," she said.

But there was more.

He licked his lower lip, said, "Does Devlin turn you on?"

"Josh, don't," she said, turning her face away.

"Sorry-sorry," he said, "not like that. I mean . . ."

"He doesn't turn me on," she said.

He touched her chin and made her look at him. "I'm not saying he turns you on. I'm saying is there some part of this . . ."

"Josh, look at me." She waited till she could tell in his eyes that he wouldn't interrupt her. "It's you that turns me on. I would do anything to turn you on."

"But Devlin . . ."

She waited, and saw that he wouldn't continue. She said, "Don't think about this too much. Don't try to figure it out."

"Figure it out?"

"It's just fun," she said. "That's all it needs to be."

He smirked, embarrassed. "Am I talking the fun right out of it?"

She kneed him lightly in the balls, making him grunt and laugh, squashing his still-hard dick against her thigh. As he moved away, she took advantage, pushing him to roll over on his back, then climbed on top of him.

"We were having some great sex," she said, straddling his hips now. His erection stuck up toward his bellybutton.

He said, “We were.”

“Put your hands over your head.”

He laughed and asked: “What are you going to do to me?”

She patted his cheek, and he closed his eyes and moved his hands over his head. “Good boy,” she said.

Now she wove her fingers between his and got her face over him. “I said we were having some great sex.”

“We were,” he said, eyes still closed.

She kissed his nose, and he opened his eyes. “That’s what matters,” she said.

His lips pursed, then he smiled. “You’re right. That’s all that matters.”

Now she smiled, and said, “So, we gamed him.”

“It feels so good,” he said, and she laughed, kissed his chin, then wriggled to suck on his nipple. His hips jostled, trying to slip down so he could put his cock in her again. She squeezed his hips with her thighs to stop him. “We have to go back down to the beach.”

“No, we don’t.”

“You know we do,” she said, and laughed.

Now she squeezed his fingers, lowered her chest to his mouth, put a nipple against his lips. He suckled. She said, “You want to keep playing?”

He released her nipple, kissed the center of her chest. “I want to keep playing all day. Maybe Devin’ll get the hint and go home.”

“That wouldn’t be any fun,” she said.

“So what you want to do?”

She let his hands go, rose up and crossed her arms. “I want to keep playing.”

“Tell him we have to go out for dinner.”

“Where’s the fun in that?”

“What do you want to do?” he asked again and put his hands on her waist.

She batted him away, said, “Put your hands over your head.”

“What are you going to do?”

Now she sat back and squashed her pussy against his cock. He groaned and smiled, then closed his eyes. She gyrated her hips, rubbing all her wetness up and down his shaft, letting him know how good and wet she was. “Let’s keep playing.”

“I want to keep playing,” he said.

“So let’s keep playing.”

“Tell me what you have in mind.”

“Devin’s nice enough to want to take us out for dinner.”

She watched him laugh. Really laugh. He looked at her. “You’re amazing. Fucking amazing.”

“I know,” she said, and scooted back and forth against his cock. He laughed and groaned, arched his back—trying to get it inside her again.

“Don’t,” she said, and patted his cheek again. “Bad boy.”

“You want him to take us out for dinner?”

“Let’s make him buy us a big steak. You’re even going to have a couple whiskeys.”

“On his dime,” Josh said, and smiled, liking her way of thinking.

“Right. And you’re going to sit there—”

“And watch you with him,” he finished.

“Can you handle it, champ?”

He moved his hands down to touch her again and she grabbed them and push them up over his head, put her face over his. She shook her head, felt her knot came fully loose and her hair fell around his neck. “I asked if you can handle it. Champ.”

“I’m pretty tough, you know,” he said.

“Let’s see how tough you are,” she said.

“Is that a challenge?”

“Hey,” she said, getting serious now.

He looked alarmed for a moment, almost disappointed. He said, “What?”

“Rules.”

“Rules,” he repeated.

She said, “This is Cayman only.”

“Cayman only?”

“This is today, tonight. That’s it. We go back to Toronto, it’s going to be over.”

“I know,” he said, understanding and nodding.

She could feel the tension of desire in him. “You got it?”

“I get it,” he said.

She said, "He's my boss when I'm back in Toronto. When I'm at work, I'm at work."

He said, "You're so serious."

She laughed, then blew a raspberry in the cup between his collarbone and neck. "I'm so serious," she said, "you're the one that's always so serious. Now you're trying to flip the tables on me."

"I love you so much," he said seriously.

She said, "I love you, too," and lay her body against his, wrapping her arms around his head and kissing his hair. And she meant it. Truly meant it. She said, "We better get going."

"Right. Before he takes off on us."

"Before he takes off on us."

"That fucking asshole," he said and laughed.

She shushed him and whispered, "Watch out. He's devious. He might be right outside the window."

Now Josh rolled her over until she fell off him. She laughed as she watched him jump out of bed, moved to the window and look out, raising a fist over his head like if he caught somebody out there he would thump them. She laughed and applauded and said, "My hero." It was amazing to see old Josh again. One from before. The boyish but unsure one, yet the one always seeking to find his confidence. There he was, making her laugh, standing naked with his dick still rock hard and wagging, fist raised over his head, faking a mean face.

He returned, climbed over top of her. She laughed and squirreled out from under him. "Let's get back down there," she said, "what if he's taking off right now? I want fun."

"I want that fun," he said, and climbed off the bed.

She gave him a cute face and said, “Well, let’s get going.”

He said, “You going down like that?”

She looked to see her bra cups pushed aside, her nipples exposed. She laughed and said, “Dress me,” tucked her hands behind her back and thrust out her chest.

Josh bit his lower lip, studied her exposed nipples, ran his fingers under the triangle cups of the bra and covered her up again. Then changed his mind and tugged one cup aside enough that a half-moon of brown nipple flesh was exposed. “Oh yeah?”

“Yeah,” he said. “And this . . .”

Now he ran a hooked finger under the scoop of her bikini bottom, tugging it over and flossing the crotch between her engorged and wet labia. She looked down and saw half of her pussy exposed, pubic hairs scrabbling out the side. She looked back at Josh, and said, “You really think so?”

“I dare you.”

She fixed her bikini bottom so they sat right. “No way, Josh,” she laughed, “no way.”

“Spoilsport,” he said.

She tugged one of the one bra cups completely aside so her breast was exposed. “How about this?”

“You wouldn’t dare.”

She walked toward the bedroom door, letting Josh see her nipple, saying, “Like I don’t even know it’s out. What do you think?”

“Oh my God,” he said, doubling over but still following behind.

She looked at his dick and said, “You’re going down like that?”

Now he laughed and said, “Absolutely no way. I can’t believe I did it in the first place. I can’t believe I let you talk me into that.”

“I’m pretty sure I could talk you into anything,” she said.

“Pretty much,” he agreed.

She was sure she was right.

Josh went to the suitcase, brought out another pair of swim trunks. “I really can’t believe I did that down there. Took my shorts off. Like holy shit, Kimmy,” him he said, sitting down on the foot of the bed and pushing his feet through the leg holes of the swim shorts. “That was crazy. Like, in high school I would’ve been so scared. I would never have done that. I can’t believe I did it.”

“I’m proud of you,” she said, fixing her bikini top, then leaning on the bedroom door. “Now let’s get down to the beach because I’m not done playing . . .”

There wasn’t an ounce of fat on Kimmy Chang’s body. His heart pounded for her.

The last hour of his life had probably been the most transformational. If there was anyone he could ever trust, it was this perfect woman.

She trotted a few steps in front, heading off the pathway and down the trail to the beach. The muscles in her legs flexed, her hips swayed, the fine muscles of her narrow back rippled under her clear and lustrous skin. And her ass . . . A taut and high rump. It made him think of how she looked in high school. A nerd. Not unlike himself. Not so much a nerd, but demure. Timid. It was through other’s prism of understanding that would have deemed them nerds. And, as much as his teenage lust drove him to Kimmy, he couldn’t deny there was a certain feeling of second place. Or hell, third place, or not even finishing.

Josh Waters in high school was not the kind of guy who would've scored with a girl like Tiffany Hanson. Not one of the other cheerleaders, either, or one of those big-makeup sly-eyed bitches who vaped. Those hot pieces of teenage ass were best left for guys like Devlin Stone; guys who were tall and masculine and played sports. Guys who had super-rich parents. So, he'd often thought those girls weren't for him, and he would have to find his place with a nerd like Kimmy Chang. What a fucking idiot he was.

This girl trotting in front of him was the most insanely hot woman he ever knew. Didn't even realize it when he married her. She was smart and funny. Beautiful. Came from a good home. She was driven and had leveraged her innate abilities into a high-paying career. Made more than he made. She was worth every penny. But more than all that, she understood him.

But then again, now here he was visualizing his amazing wife through the perspective of another.

Did Kimmy suddenly have more value to him because Devlin saw it as well? What a shitty thing to think. What a terrible way for your mind to work.

But it was true. All this time he's thinking that Kimmy's sexuality is coming out because she'd been aroused by Devlin, but maybe (like she'd said) it was from him. He was more attracted to her because he was driven mad by a jealous rage these days. And that jealous rage came from a guy who would have barely looked at Kimmy Chang in high school. But holy shit did Devlin Stone see the value in Kimmy Chang now. Kimmy Waters, that is.

But this trip to Cayman had solidified his heart. No more of that wasteful thinking. Browbeating himself.

Watching her butt bounce under the tight constraint of her satiny black bikini bottom, he felt a thousand miles and years transported from that night he'd secretively snuck into the city and skulked around the Royal York Hotel to catch her in the act. And he'd wanted to catch her. What an odd obsession.

And on cue, they emerged into the bright sunlight and out from the canopy of shade under the colonnade of Caribbean brush. Underneath his thoughts as he descended the trail, a growing dreadful angst had tightened his chest. Would they emerge in the sunlight to find Devlin walking around naked with that big disgusting dick flopping between his legs?

Kimmy had seen it. Kimmy had seen what a big penis looked like. A really big penis. It didn't look like anything she'd seen before, he imagined. Heavy but soft, a thick sleeve of wrinkled skin that bunched around the large shape of his cock head. It had beat against his thighs as he walked. And Kimmy saw it.

Shoot, if his erection wasn't throbbing harder. But out in the sunlight now, despite the fear, he didn't feel relieved. Devlin wore his trunks.

But it didn't defeat his spirit. He smiled the boastful smile of a man who just fucked a hot girl. Like teenage Josh would have if he'd scored with Tiffany at a party, he showed Devlin a brash and exuberant expression. He wanted there to be no doubt in Devlin's mind about what he and Kimmy'd just engaged in.

"Hey, hey," he said, "sorry about that. Kimmy had a lot more to tell me than she anticipated." He hoped his cheeks were red from the sex and didn't even care that his erection showed in his trunks. He touched Kimmy's face, and she turned her eyes away, bashful. Yep, there would be no doubt in Devlin's mind whether they'd fucked. They definitely had. And it had been good. Probably even better than a guy like Devlin could have anticipated from Josh. He liked to say to this guy who'd haunted his thoughts for the last few months that anything he thought he held over Josh Waters would blow away—like a hand thought to be clenching a weapon, the hand would open and a stiff breeze would blow away only dust. Fuck Devlin.

Kimmy said, "Sorry about that, we got carried away."

"Don't mind me," Devlin said, "I'm enjoying the sea."

Josh said, "You swim out to Cuba and back already?"

Devlin said, “Cuba?”

Josh pointed out to the water and said, “It’s straight out that way.” Idiot.

Devlin said, “No, swam out pretty far though. Saw some dolphins.”

Kimmy brightened. “You did not.”

“They were close to me,” Devlin said, looking over her shoulder, the act of twisting getting the muscles of his stomach to flex. And for the strangest reason, he hoped now that Kimmy had seen it— And holy shit, could she not see the outline of Devlin’s cock right now . . .?

His eyes shifted to Kimmy, and she did indeed see it. A tubular shape humped out between Devlin’s legs and angled down below the crotch of his shorts. That sagging slab of man flesh was partly aroused. And now Josh couldn’t wait to get Kimmy alone again so he could tease her. Tell her: Looks like Devlin was hard under the water. He got hard looking at your fucking amazing body half naked in the sun. What can the guy do, he’s only human?

And now a smile spread. Devlin saw it. A twinkle in Devlin’s devilish eyes brought the first return of his anxiety. Devlin wasn’t threatened. He didn’t look defeated. He looked happy.

Devlin said, “They were about fifty yards out from me. I only saw their dorsal fins until one raised up out of the water.”

Kimmy said, “You sure it wasn’t sharks?”

Devlin said, “For a sec I thought I was in trouble, but no, definitely dolphins. I was relieved when I saw that one crest out of the water.”

“I wish I’d been here,” Kimmy said.

And there was another dent in Josh’s new armor. Would she prefer to be down here watching dolphins with Devlin?

Shit, Josh, was she going to have to hold your hand through this every day?

Now he smiled again. No. It was on him now to make this work. And what a fucking gift. This guy right in front of them, the guy who taunted him all those years ago—who'd made his high school life miserable, had fucked with him at a house party ten years after graduation—thought he had the upper hand. But Josh had the upper hand. Josh had him beat.

He stretched now, stepped back to the lounge chair, picked up the decanter of single malt, and poured himself a short glass. He took a sip and enjoyed it. He liked bourbon. Single malt was in the same family. A little peaty, sure, but what the hey, this was probably pretty expensive and every dollar of it came in some way from Devlin Stone's pocket. Or his father's.

He put the glass down and said, "I think I worked up an appetite," and then looked to Kimmy. I set you up, baby . . .

Kimmy said, "Me too. I'm hungry as well," and stepped closer to Devlin.

Devlin said, "My offer stands. I was gonna take you out for dinner. You guys didn't want me."

"Josh," Kimmy said in a pleading sort of voice, the points of her eyebrows tenting her smooth brow. A wife asking for her husband's permission.

His heart beat strong. He said, "You know what? I think I'd like that."

Kimmy pivoted, swinging herself to pivot on her toes, digging them into the sand and swishing toward Devlin. Her arms went behind her back, and her chest thrust out.

The way Devlin's eyes dipped downward to Kimmy's pointed B cups was like a caress on his balls. He gulped air straight into his stomach; the sight was powerful. Kimmy's nipples pressed out the fabric of her bikini, and the sun cast shadows to pronounce them.

Josh's mouth sagged open. Devlin straight-up looking at Kimmy Chang's tits. And Kimmy standing right next to him, the musclebound hunk who'd just taken his shorts down to show off the big dick he had. Husband-and-wife working against the world's biggest asshole.

Josh set himself down to sit on the lounge and crossed his legs to hide the bulge in his swim trunks. He showed Devlin how relaxed he was, melting his bare back against the lounge, and slumping low in it; a man without worry.

He said, "I think it's a good idea. You going to take us out for dinner tonight, Devlin?"

Beside oblivious Devlin, Kimmy smiled deviously.

Afterword

Another episode with Kimmy, Josh, and Devlin will be coming soon!—join me on Patreon to read further ahead . . .

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